Eduvos Assessment Coversheet

Academic Details

Campus: **Eduvos Bedfordview Campus**

Faculty: **IT Faculty**

Module Code: **ITECA3-34**

Lecturer's Name: **Mpho Thobejane**

Group (if applicable) **1**

Assessment Details

Assessment Type: **Summative Assessment**

Assignment/Brief Number:

Due Date/ Submission Date: **6 November 2026**

Student Details (Group, if applicable)

#	Full Name	Student Number	Contact Number	% Participation	Signature
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					

Student Details (Individual, if applicable)

Student Full Name: **Nkosinathi Osmond Mothudi**

Student Number: **CON-1469933-Q0Z3**

Academic Integrity

AI Disclosure Completed ● **Yes** ☐ **No**

Declaration:
I declare that this assessment is my own original work except for source material explicitly acknowledged. I confirm that this work has not previously been submitted for assessments in any course. I acknowledge the institutional AI policy and confirm that AI tools have only been used as stipulated and documented in the AI Disclosure Appendix.

Student Signature 

Date **2026/11/04**

Lecturer Use Only

Lecturer Comments:

Marks Awarded (%):

Lecturer Signature:

Date:

E-COMMERCE APP USER MANUAL

ITECA3-34 Project

Table of Contents

Eduvos Assessment Coversheet 0
Introduction 4
Scope 4
Application Description 4
System objectives 4
Application Architecture 5
Main Application features 5
System Requirements 5
Access Requirements 6
Role-based access control 6
Customer User Manual 6
Administrator User Manual 20
Payment Gateway Integration 29
Application Maintenance 30
Deployment configuration 30
Troubleshooting 33
AI Disclosure Appendix 35
Declaration: 35

Introduction

The purpose of this user manual is to provide instructions for customer use, administrative use and maintainability of the True Gent Africa e-commerce application. The manual is intended to aid customers, administrators, and developers in understanding the application functionality and perform task effectively.

Scope

This manual covers:

- Customer sign-in/log-in, authentication and password resetting.
- Browsing products.
- Adding product to cart.
- Checkout and payment processing.
- Customer communication.
- Administrative access.
- Product, order management and delivery communication.
- Application setup.
- Database setup.

The e-commerce application pertains to:

User Type	Description
Customers	Individuals who use the application to browse and purchase products.
Administrators	Authorized individuals who use the application to manage products, orders and view business metrics.
Developers	Technical team who are responsible for the development, configuration, maintenance and updating of the application.

Application Description

True Gent Africa is a web-based e-commerce platform that allows customers to browse products, add products to their shopping cart, submit a form to communicate with True Gent personnel, and purchase True Gent Africa's product online.

The application also provides an administrative interface through which only authorized individuals can access, view and manage orders, and products as well and view all customers and their orders with True Gent Africa.

Developers are responsible for the maintenance of the application's source code, database, UI and overall functionality.

System objectives

The objectives of the application are:

- Provide customers with seamless shopping experience.
- Enable secure sign-in/log-in and authentication.

- Enable customers to purchase products.
- Provide administrators with the ability to manage e-commerce operations efficiently
- Record and maintain order, product, and customer information

Application Architecture

Component	Technology
Frontend	HTML, CSS, JavaScript
Backend	PHP
Database	MySQL
Web Server	Apache
Payment Gateway	PayFast
Development Environment	XAMPP
Version Control	Git, GitHub

Main Application features

Feature	Description
User Authentication	Allows users to sign-in or log-in
Password Resetting	Allows a user to reset their password if they have forgotten their password via email that is integrated in the platform.
Add to Cart	Allows a user to add a product to the shopping cart
Product Catalog	Allows a user to browse, select a product and view product information
Customer Contact	Allows a user to submit a contact form
Checkout	Allow a user to fill out a checkout form and place an order
Payment Processing	Allow a user to pay for their order using an external gateway that is integrated with the platform.
Order management	Allow administrators to view orders made by customers.
Delivery communication	Allows administrators to send an email via an automated that is integrated into the application.
Admin dashboard	Allow administrators to view recent orders made, see current revenue made, total customers and orders made.
Product management	Allow administrators to update product prices and inventory.

System Requirements

Hardware Requirements

Component	Minimum requirement
Processor	Intel Core i3 or higher
RAM	8GB RAM or higher

Storage	500gb or higher

Software Requirements

Software	Requirement
Operating System	Windows / Linux / MacOS
Web Browser	Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Safari, Firefox, Arc
Web Server	Apache
Backend	PHP
Database	MySQL
Development Tools	Visual Studio Code / Other
Managed Hosting	AlwaysData

Access Requirements

- Customers require a signed/logged in account to have access specific features such as being able to view their orders.
- Administrators require authorized administrator credentials.
- Developers require access to the application's source code and development environment.

Role-based access control

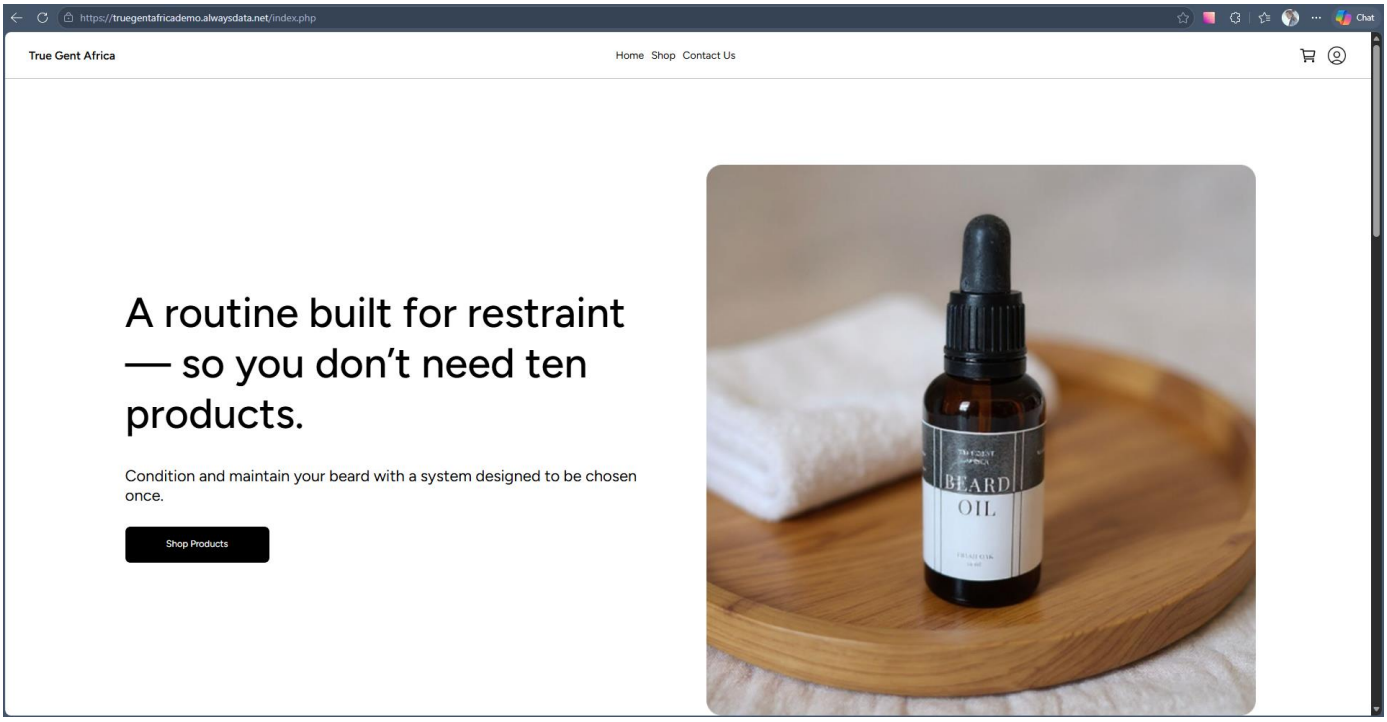
Functionality	Customer	Administrator	Developer
Browse products	Yes	Yes	Yes
Purchase products	Yes	Optional	Optional
Update password	Yes	Yes	Yes
Contact TGA personnel	Yes	No	Through development
Manage products	No	Yes	Through development
Manage orders	No	Yes	Through development
Access admin dashboard	No	Yes	Yes
Modify source code	No	No	Only if authorized to do so.
Manage database structure	No	No	Through development

Customer User Manual

Accessing the website

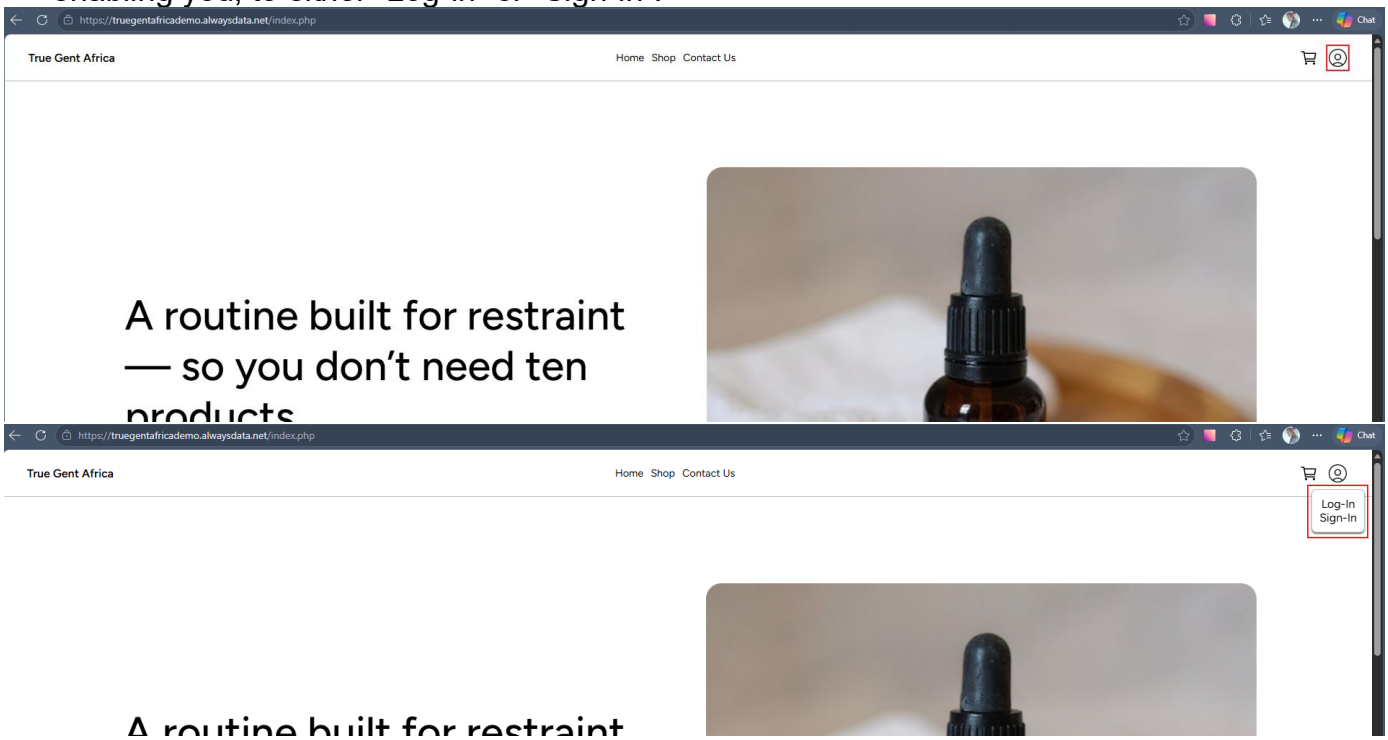
Purpose: To explain how customers/users can access the website

1. Open your dedicated web browser
2. Enter this URL: https://truegentafricademo.alwaysdata.net/index.php
3. Press Enter
4. The website homepage should be displayed in guest mode.

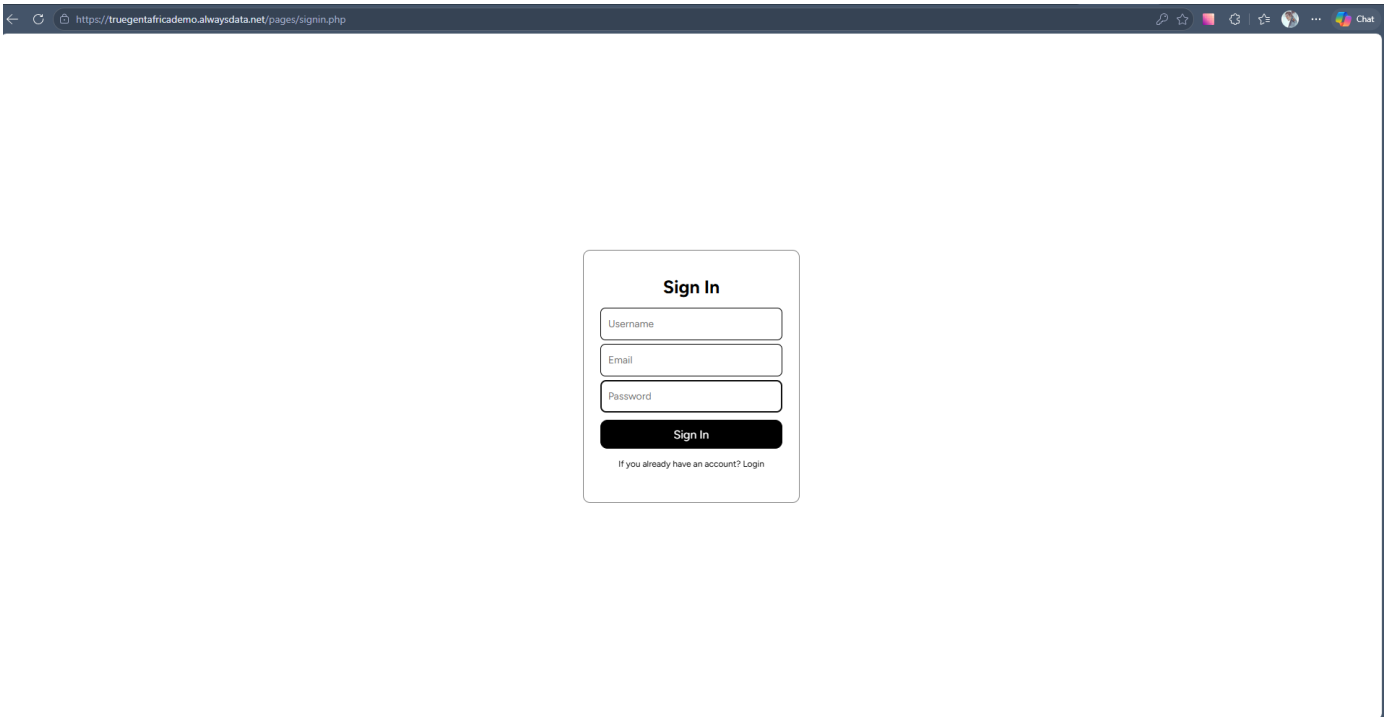


Customer Sign-in

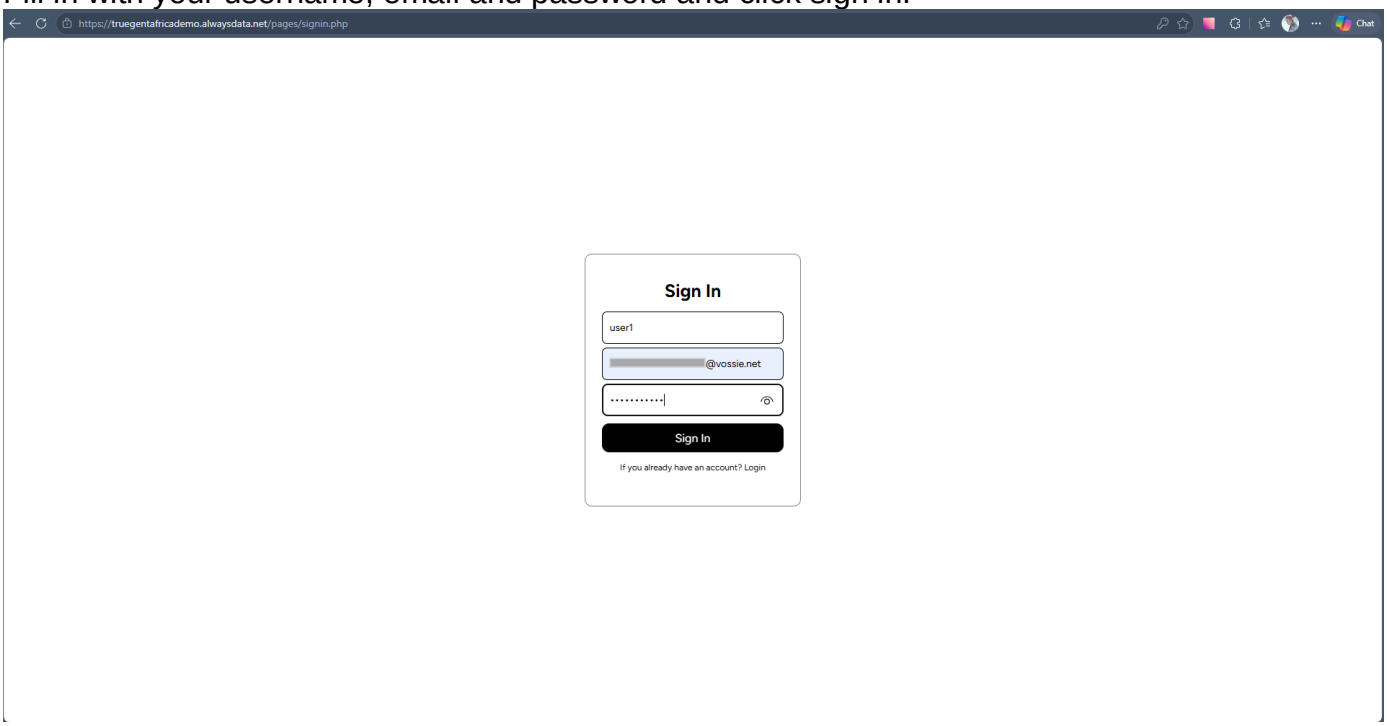
1. Navigate with your cursor to the account icon and click it, as a dropdown menu should appear enabling you, to either “Log-in” or “Sign-in”.



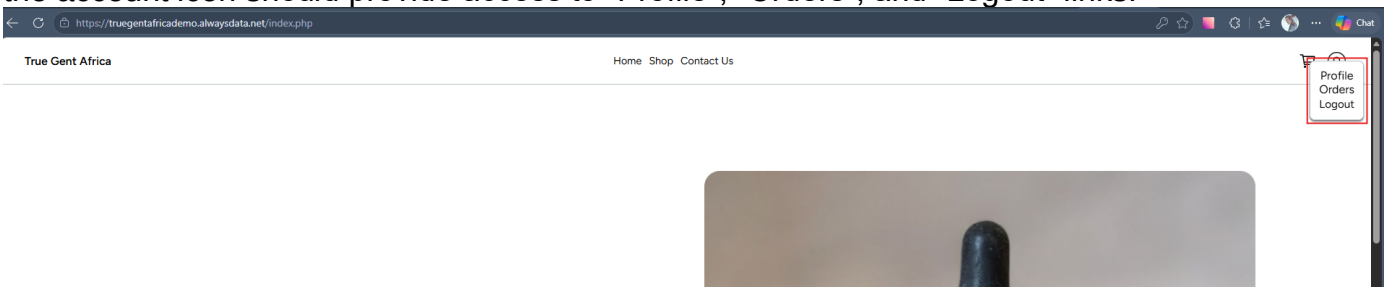
2. Clicking sign-in takes you to the sign-in page where a customer can sign in into their account.



3. Fill in with your username, email and password and click sign in.

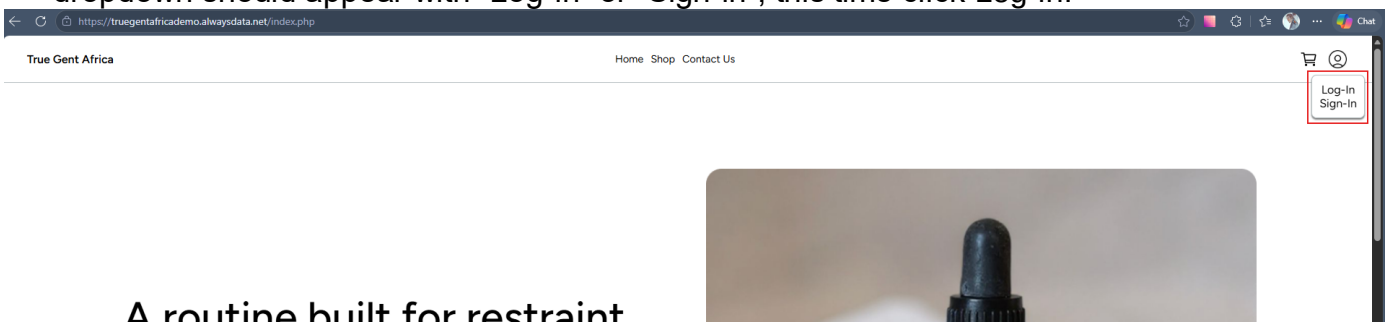


4. After successfully signing in, you are redirected to the homepage, the dropdown from clicking the account icon should provide access to “Profile”,” Orders”, and “Logout” links.

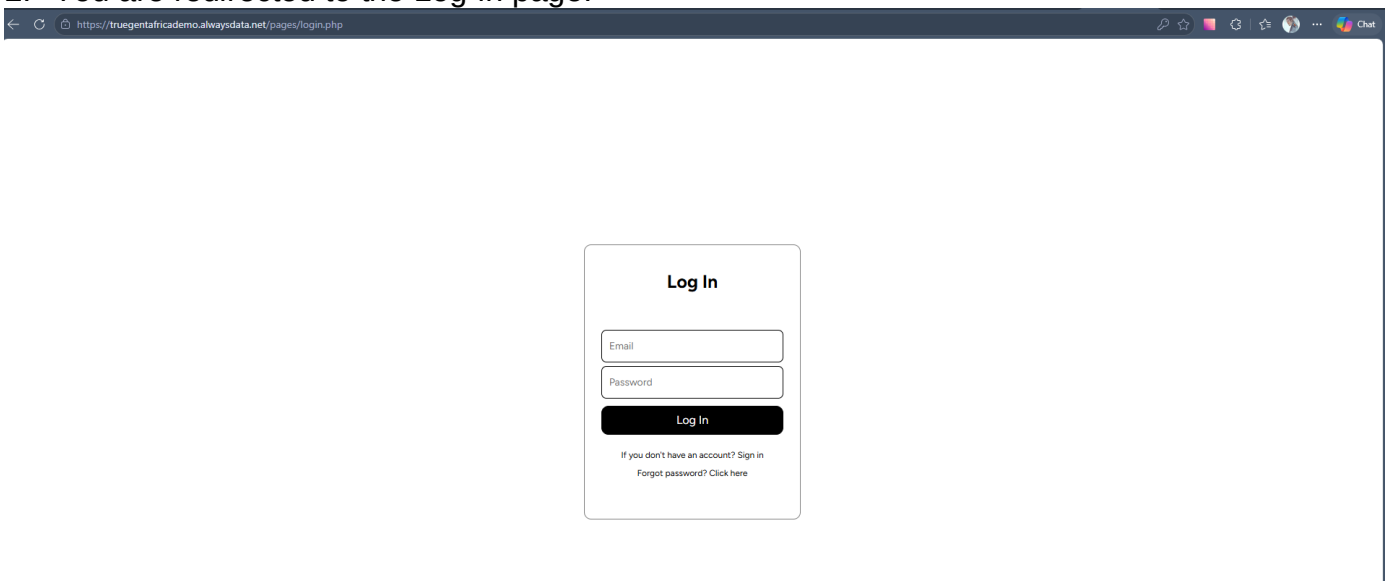


Customer Login

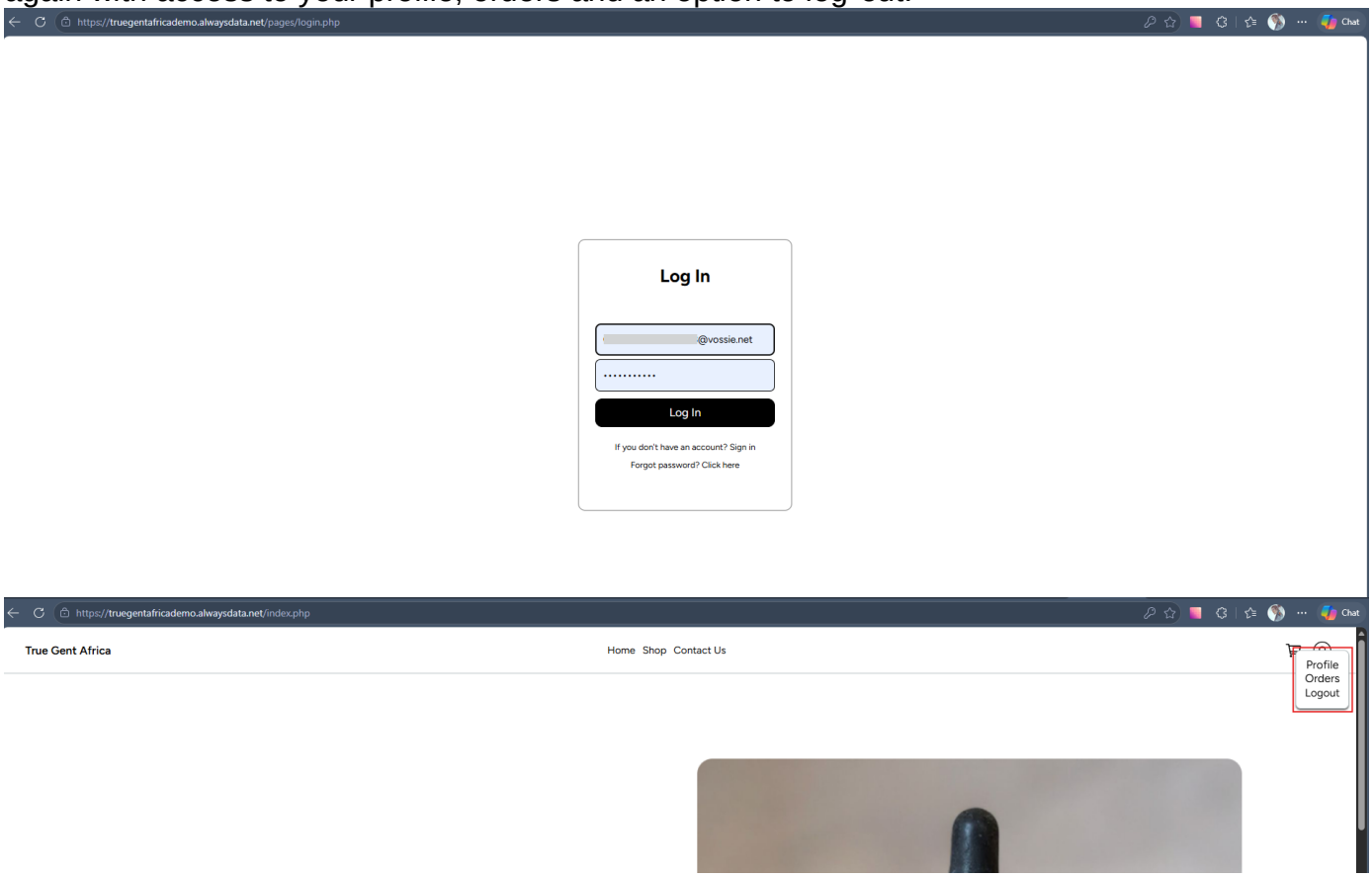
1. In the guest state of the application, navigate your cursor to the account icon, click it. A dropdown should appear with “Log-in” or “Sign-in”, this time click Log-in.



2. You are redirected to the Log-in page.

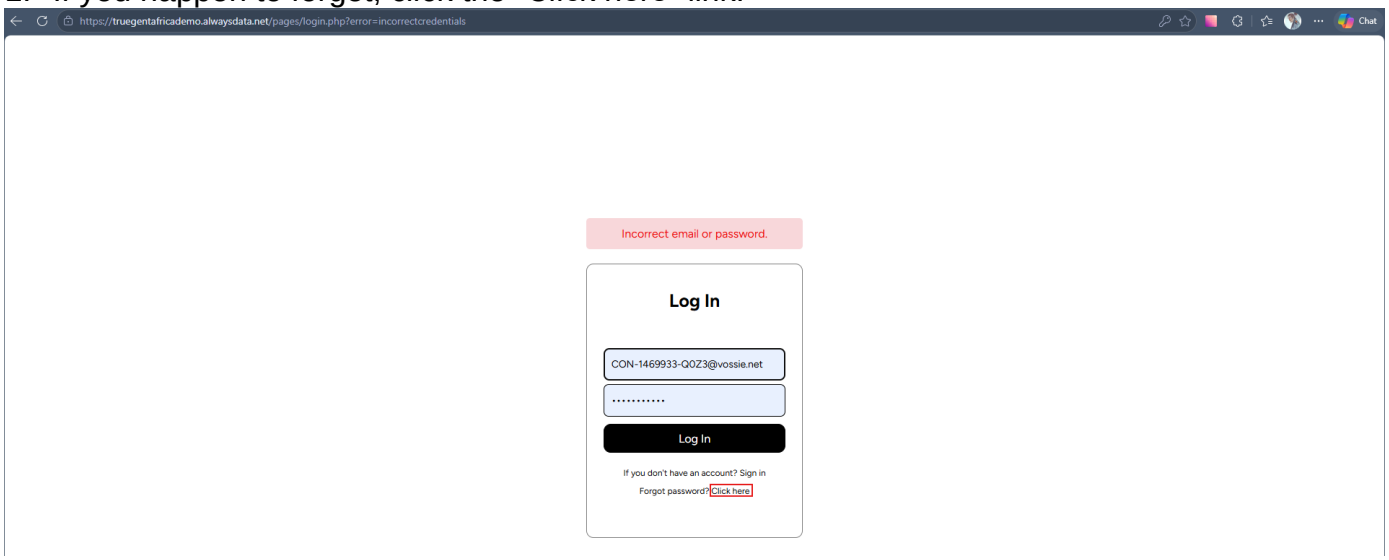


3. Fill in your email and password and click log-in and you be redirected to the home page again with access to your profile, orders and an option to log-out.

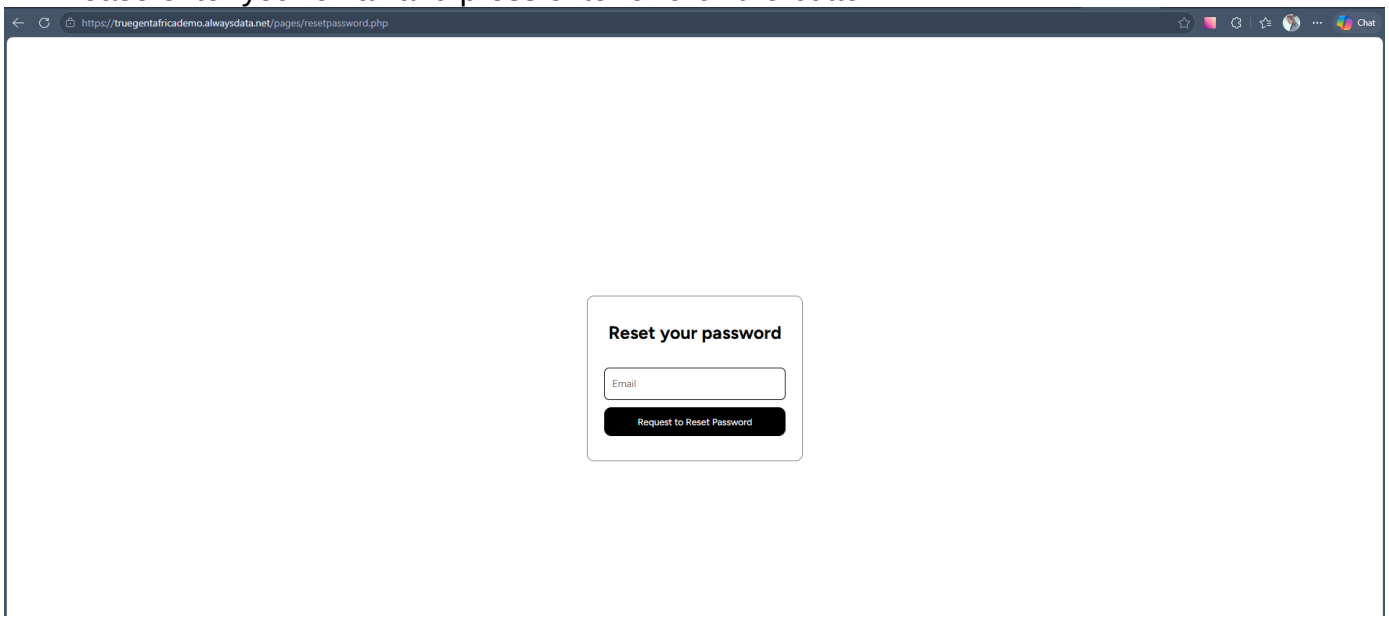


Password Forgetting and Reset

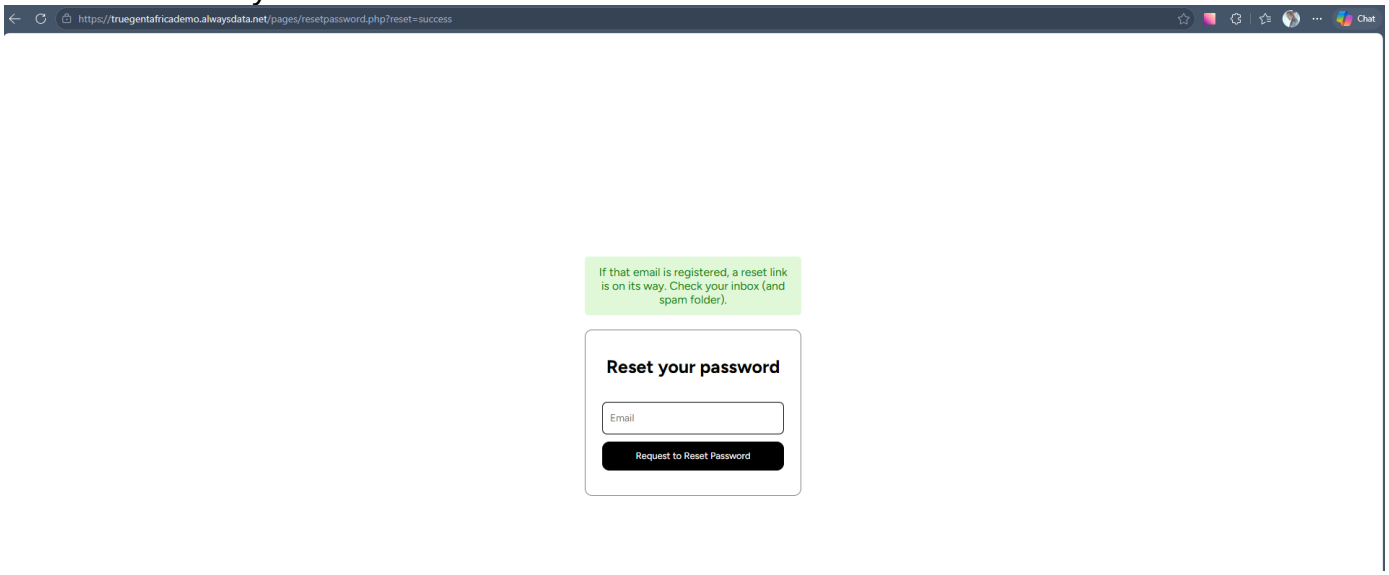
1. If you happen to forget, click the “Click here” link.



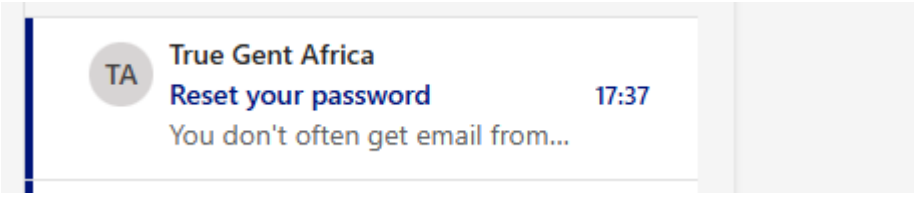
2. Please enter your email and press enter or click the button.



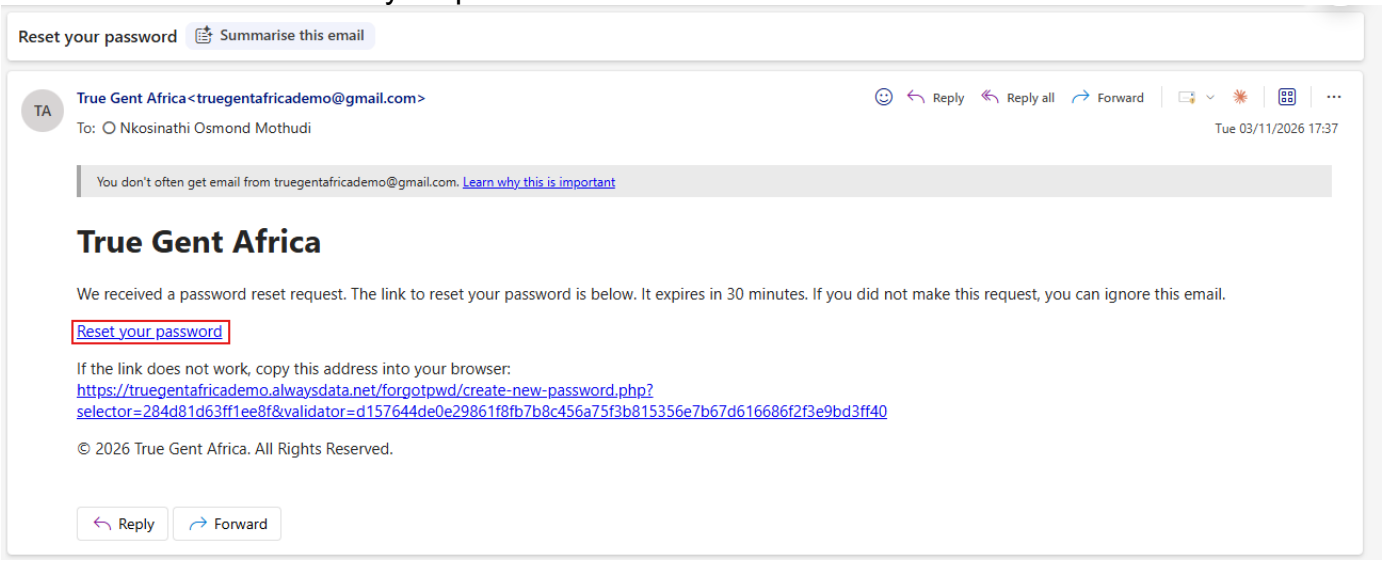
3. Please check your email inbox as indicated.



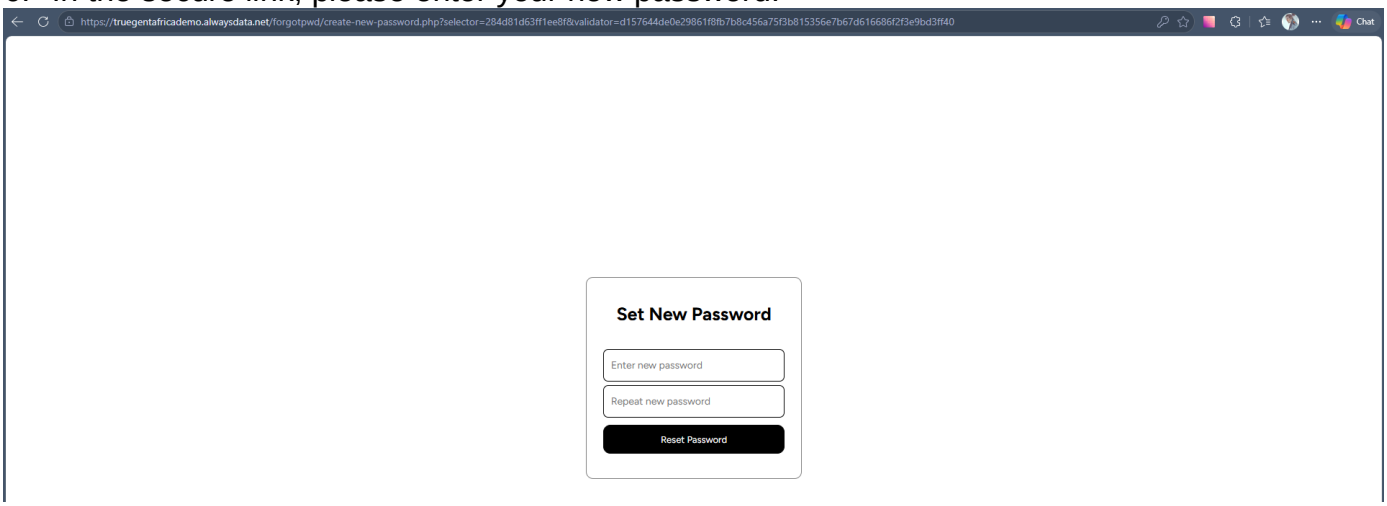
4. In your inbox, you should receive an email enabling you to reset your password.



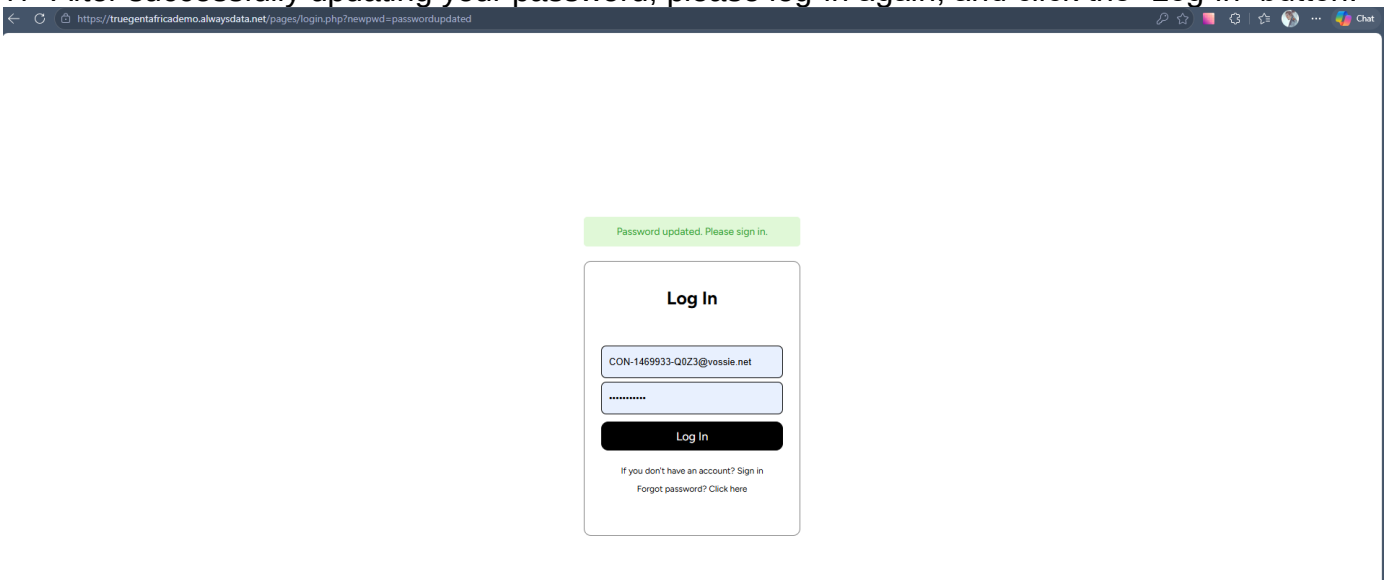
5. Please click the “Reset your password” URL.



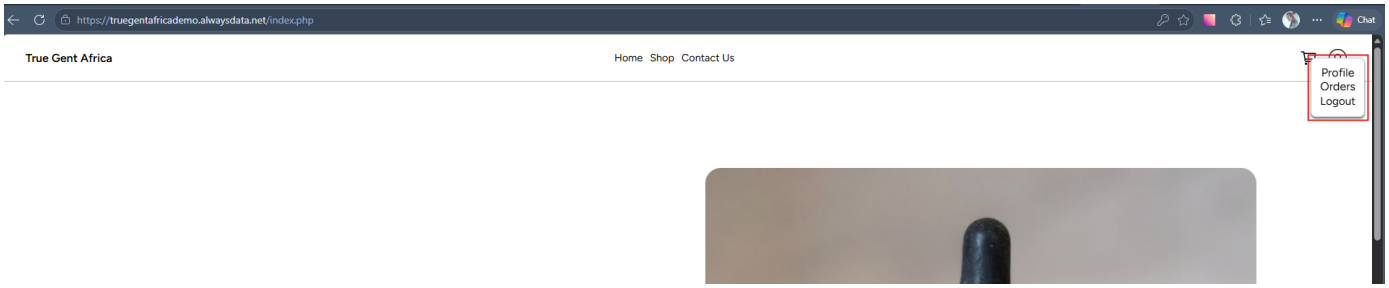
6. In the secure link, please enter your new password.



7. After successfully updating your password, please log-in again, and click the “Log-in” button.

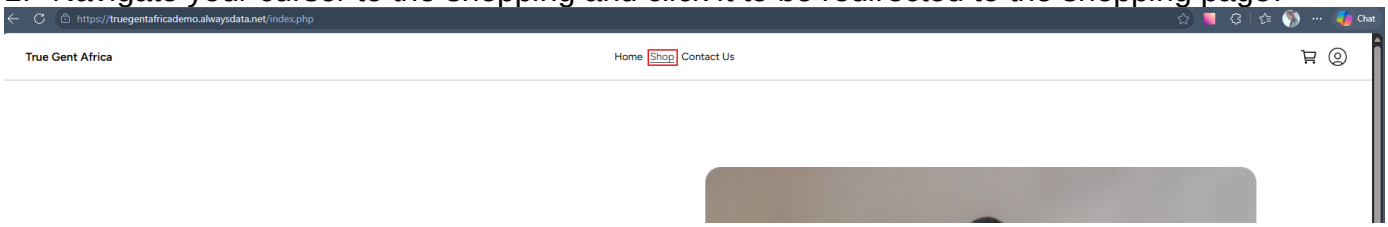


8. You should be successfully redirected to the home page with access to your profile and orders.

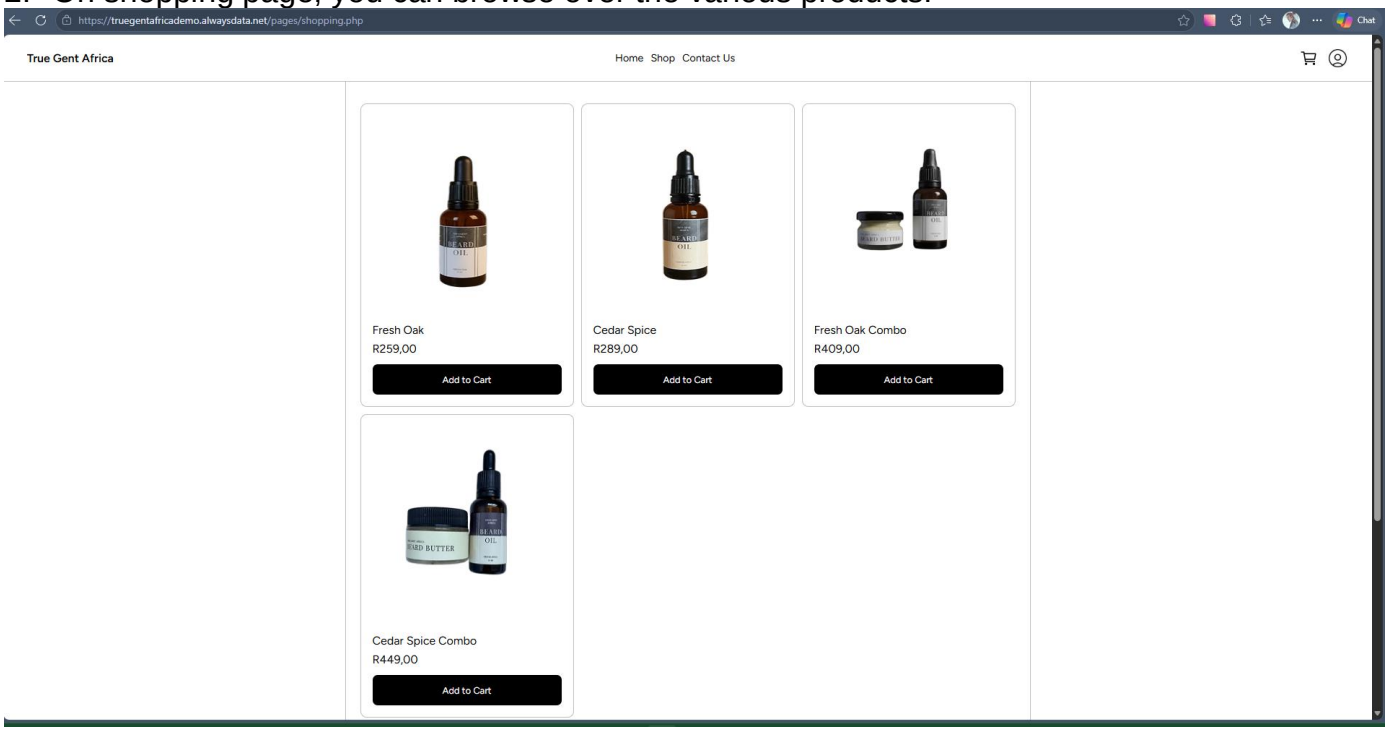


Browsing products

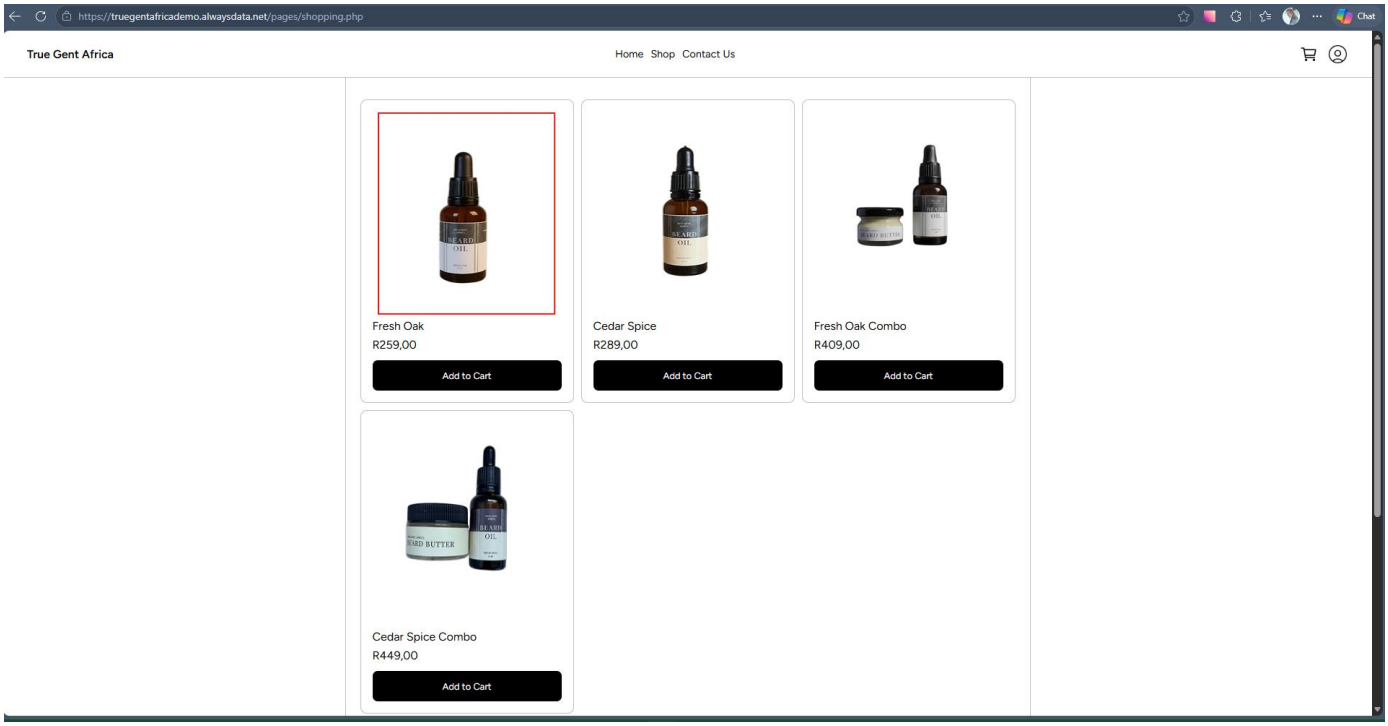
1. Navigate your cursor to the shopping and click it to be redirected to the shopping page.



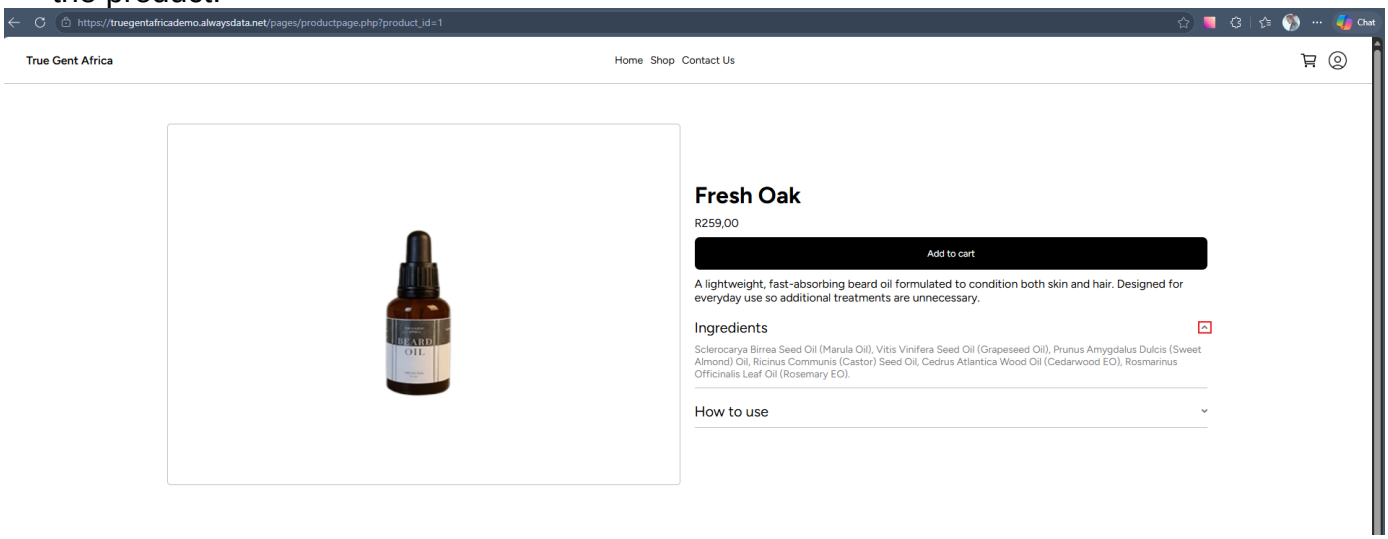
2. On shopping page, you can browse over the various products.



3. Click on any of the products available to be redirected to a product page by hovering your cursor over any of the products.

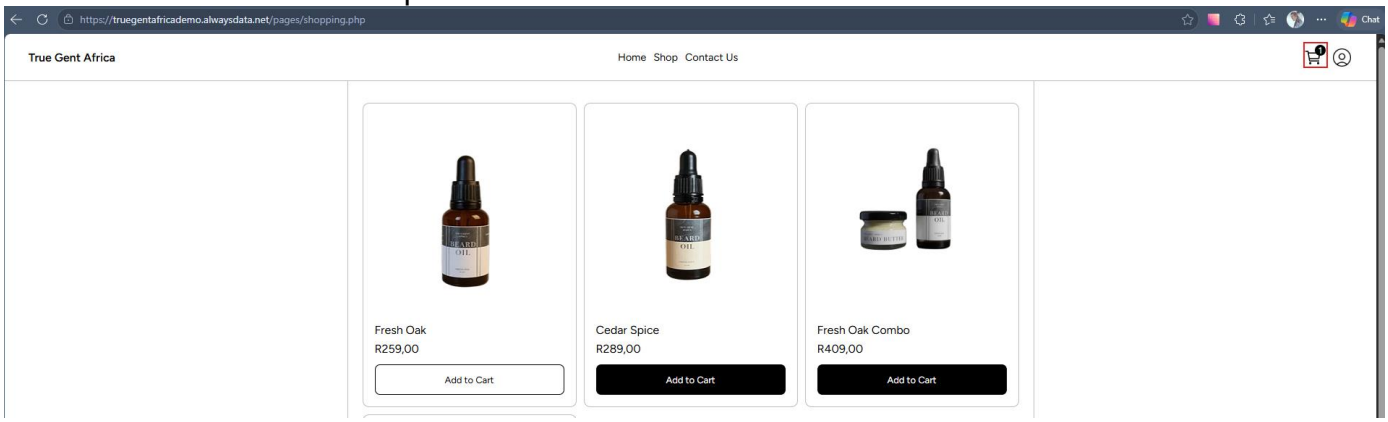


4. You should be redirected to a product page where you can see additional information about the product.

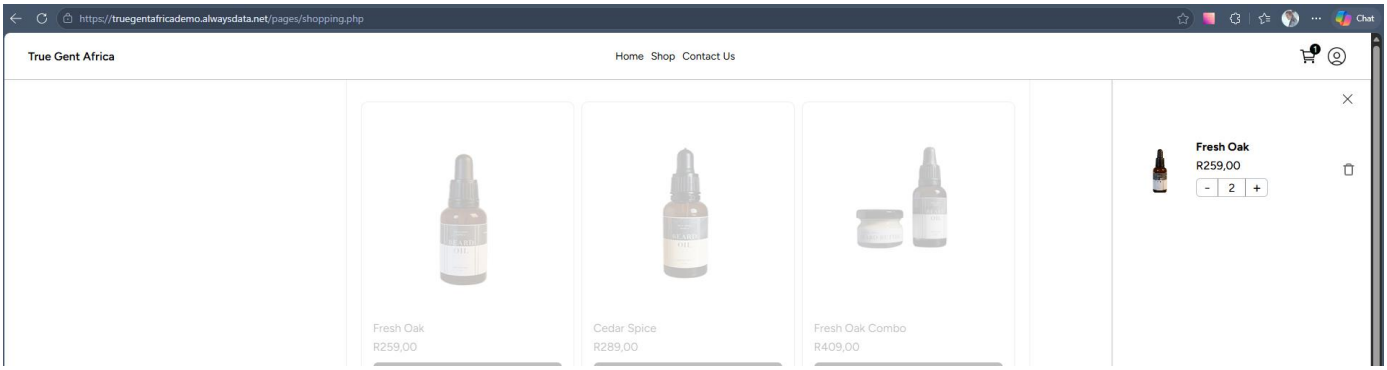


<u>Adding to the Cart</u>

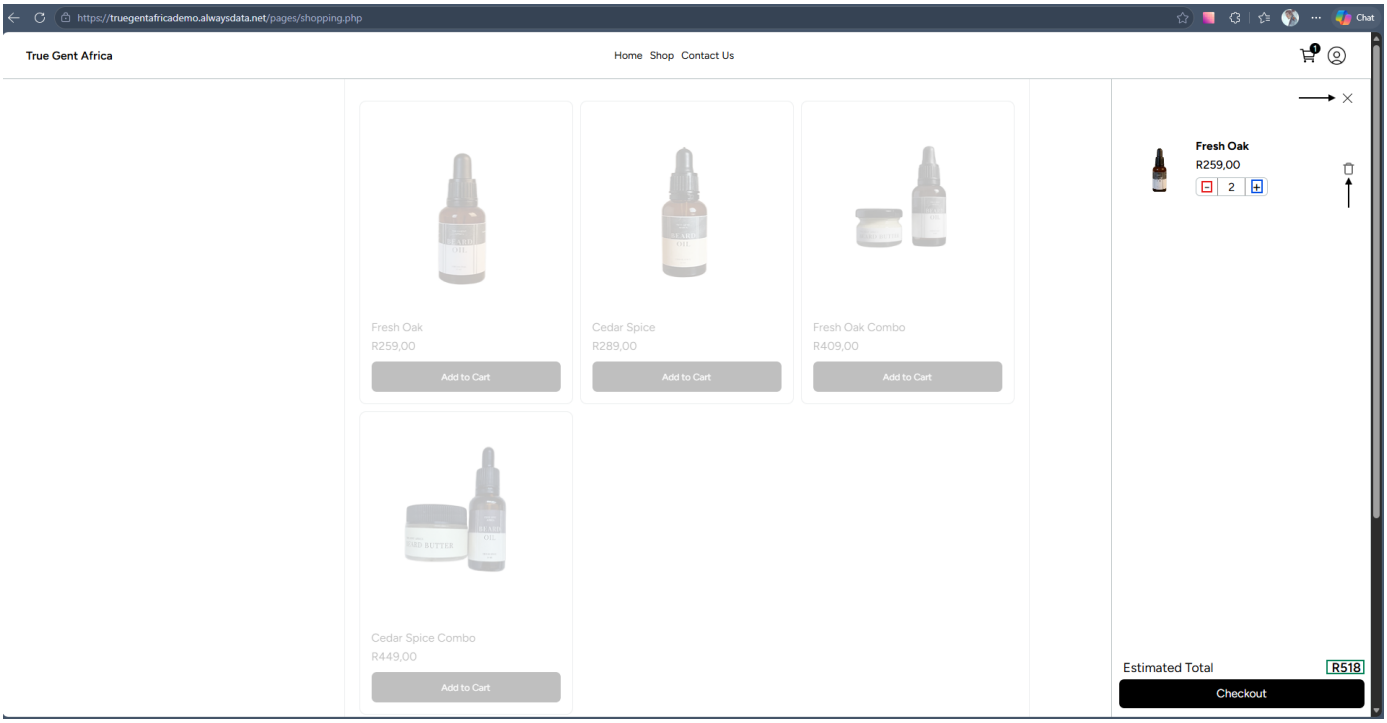
1. Clicking the “Add to Cart” button, adds a product to your cart and is saved. The system will represent your action by seeing a counter attached to the cart icon. The customer can add to the cart a maximum of 4 products.



2. Clicking on your cart, should open a cart drawer.

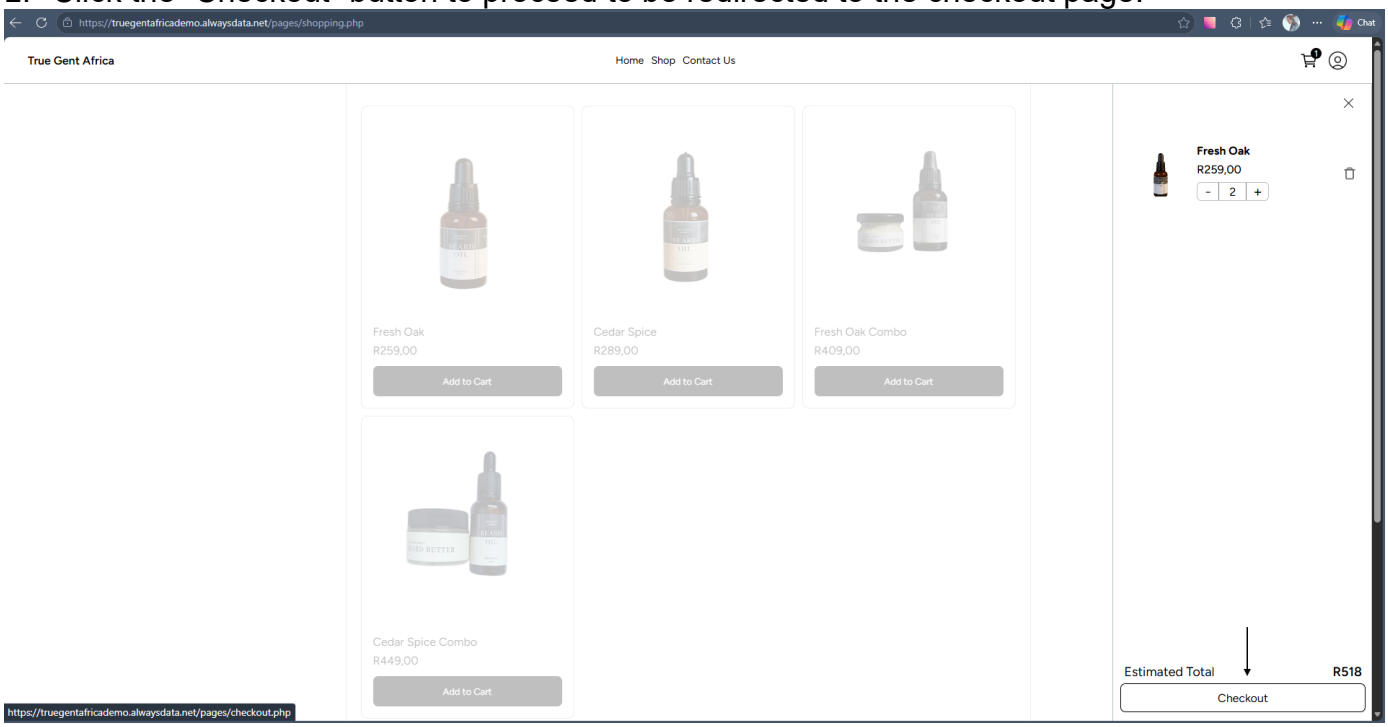


3. In the cart drawer, you can increase the quantity, view the estimated total, delete your selection and close the cart.

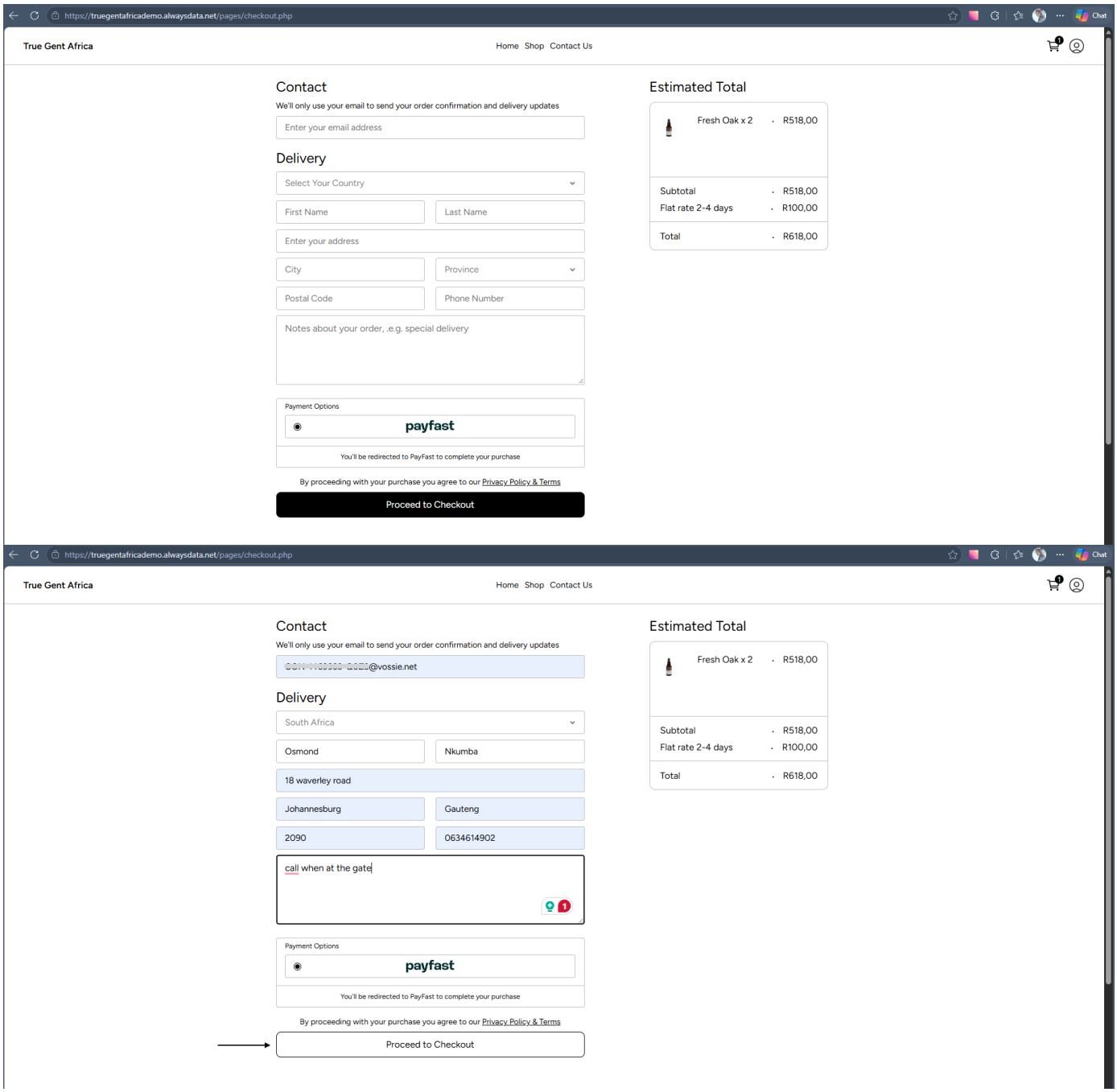


Checkout

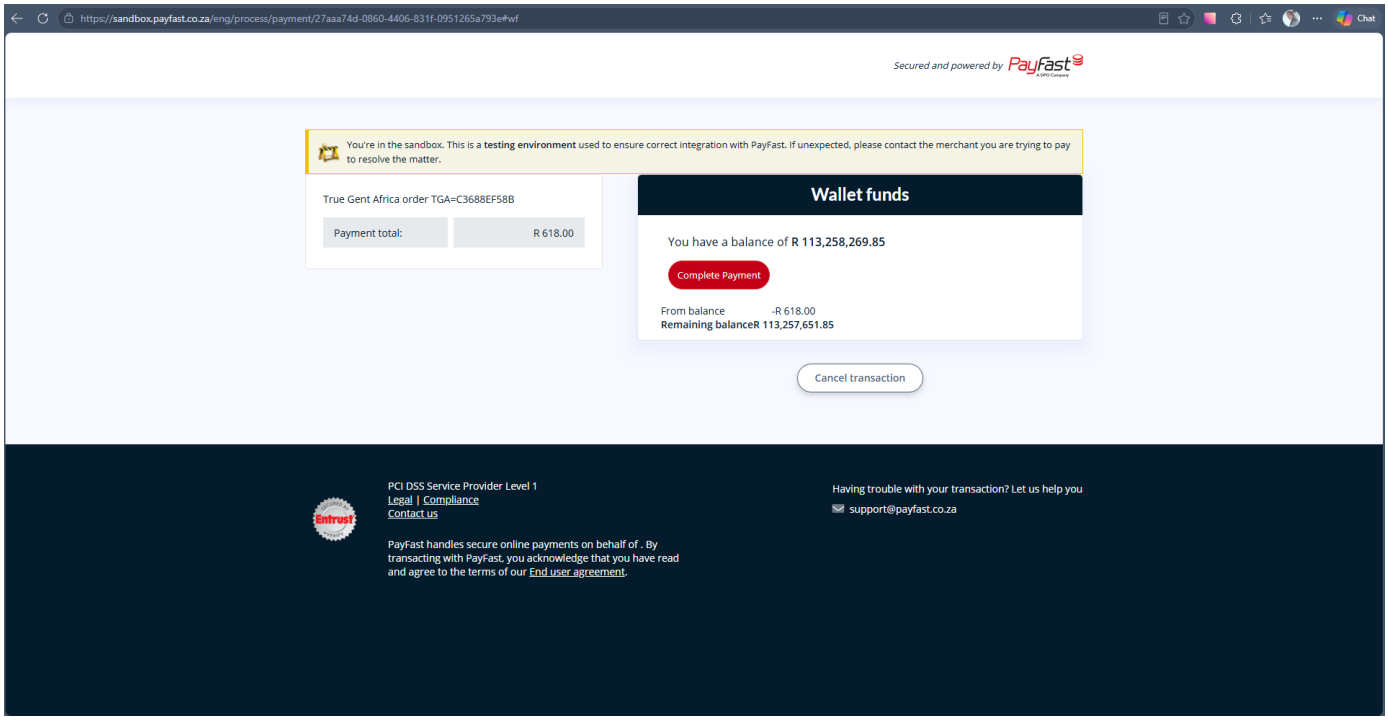
1. Click the “Checkout” button to proceed to be redirected to the checkout page.



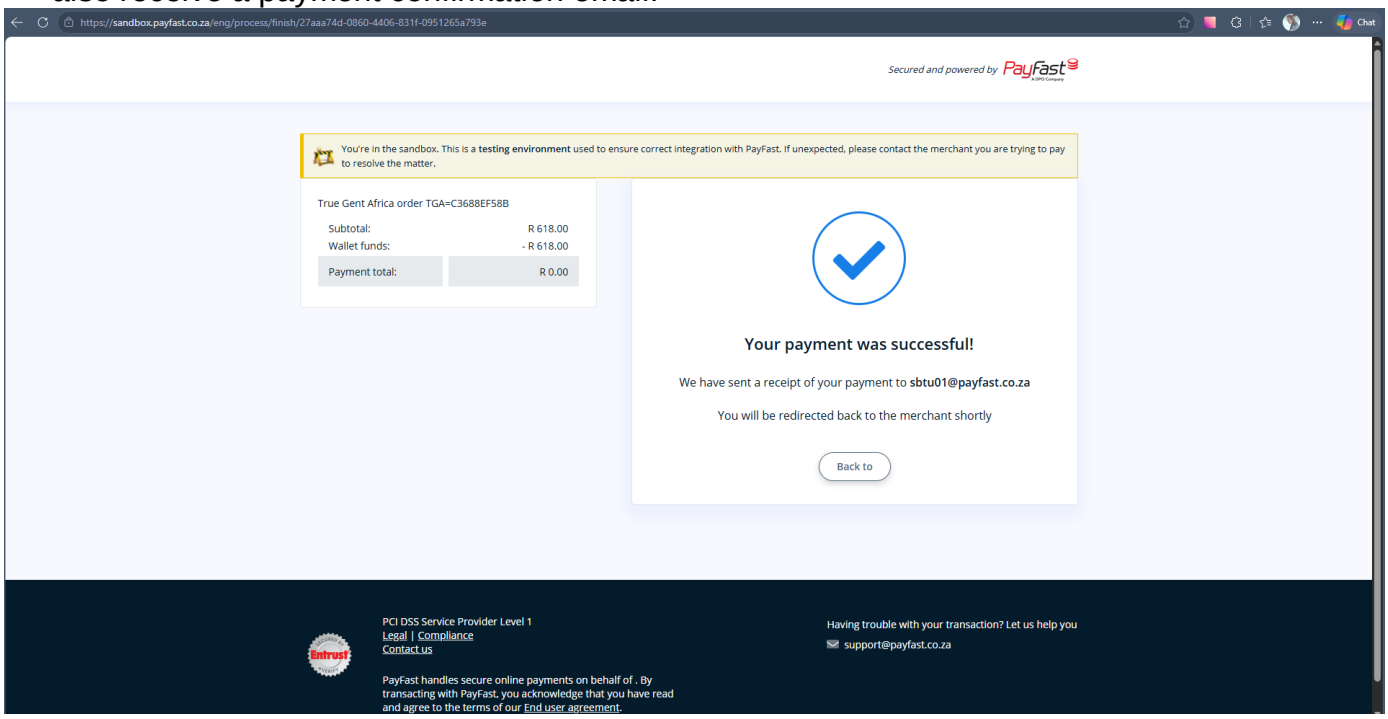
2. Fill in the checkout form and click “Proceed to Checkout”.

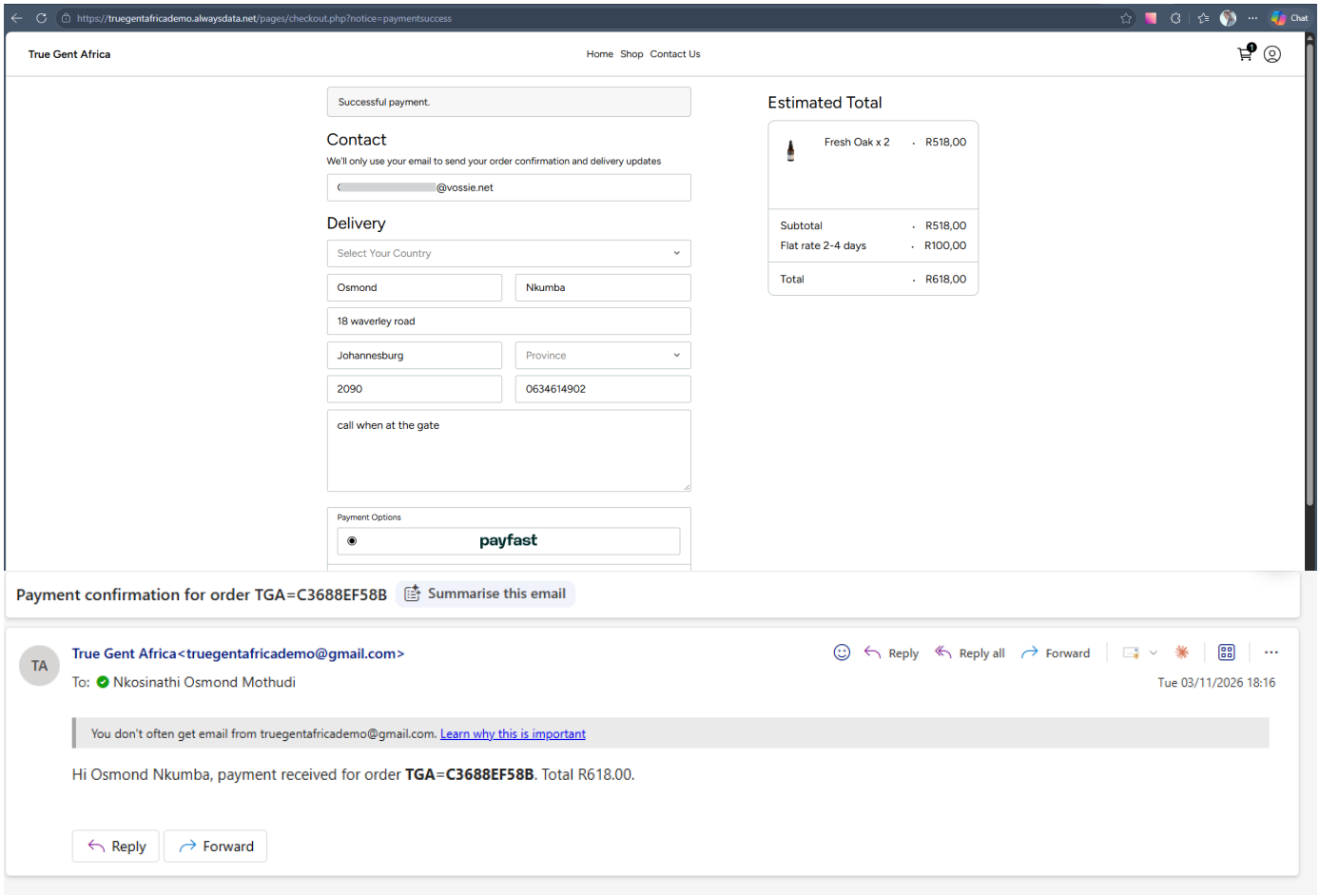


3. You should be redirected the PayFast payment gateway to complete your payment.



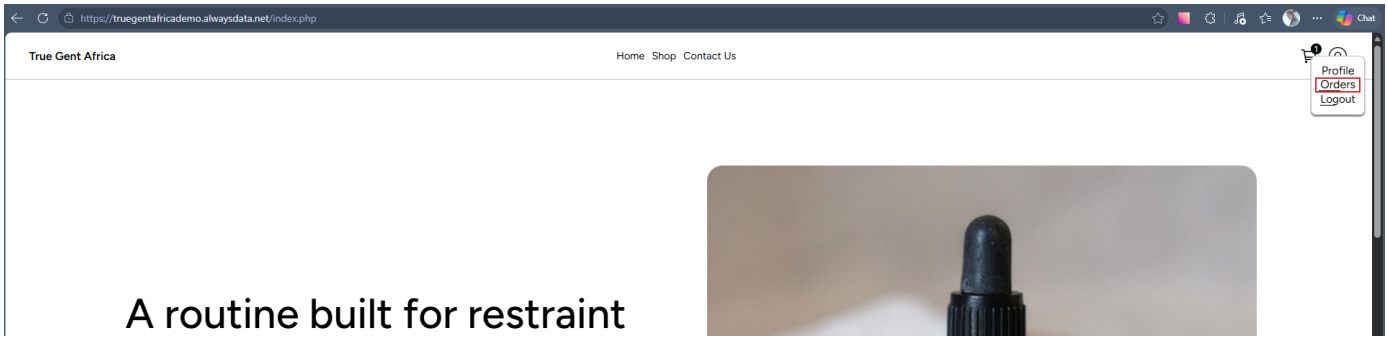
4. After successful payment you will be redirected back to e-commerce platform. Note you will also receive a payment confirmation email.



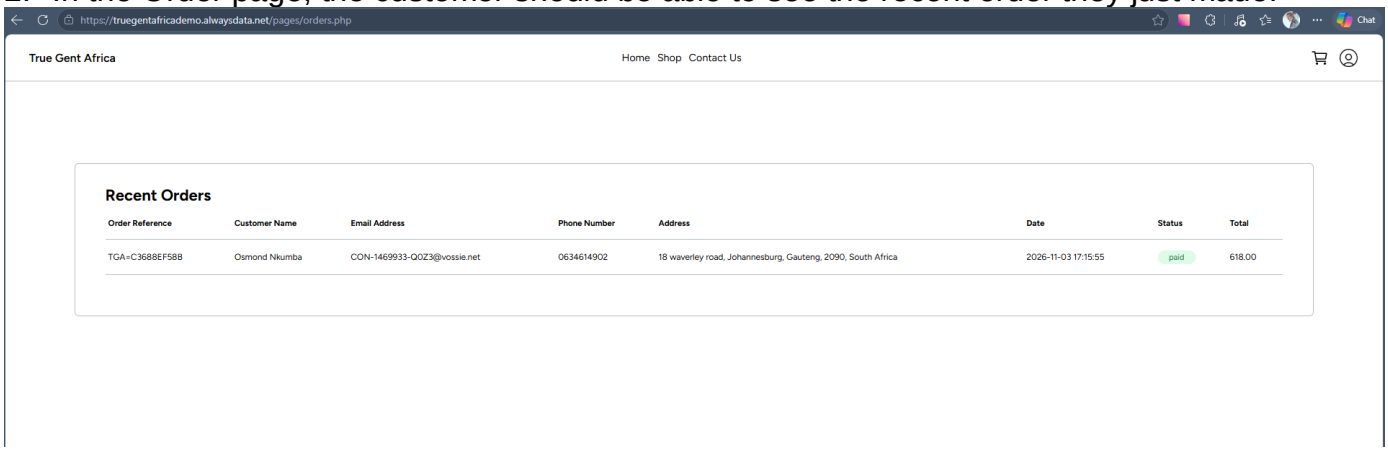


Orders

1. Navigate your cursor to the account icon, click to display the dropdown menu and click on the Orders URL.

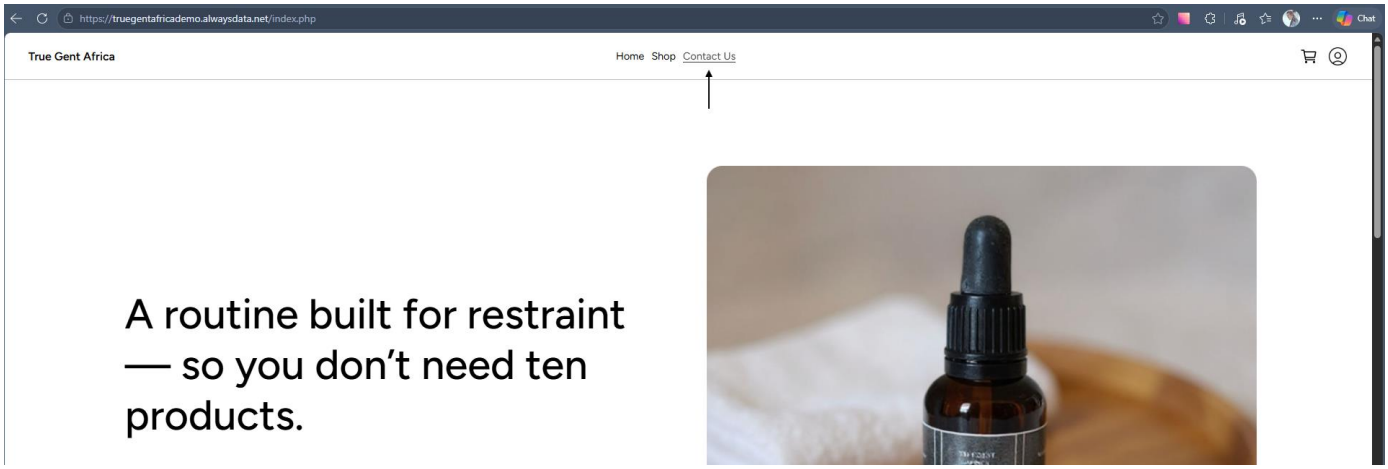


2. In the Order page, the customer should be able to see the recent order they just made.

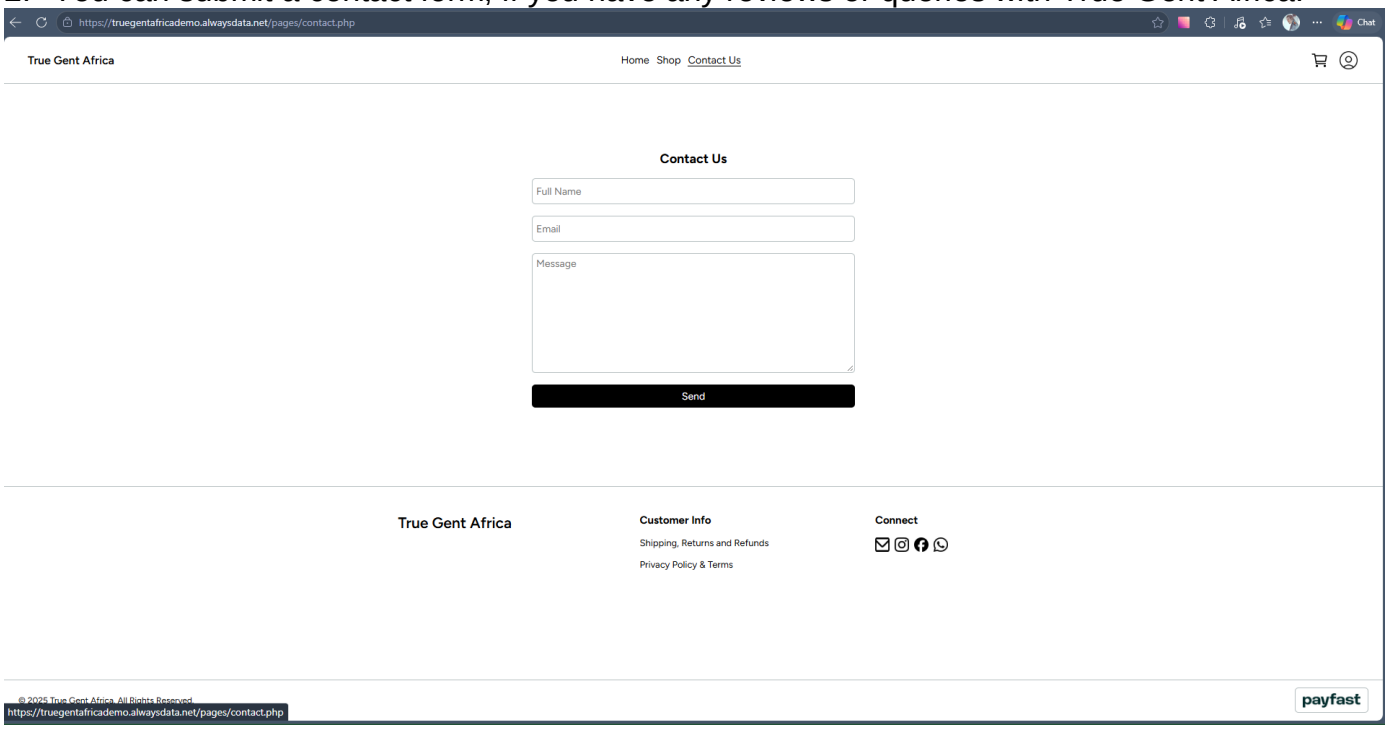


Contact Us

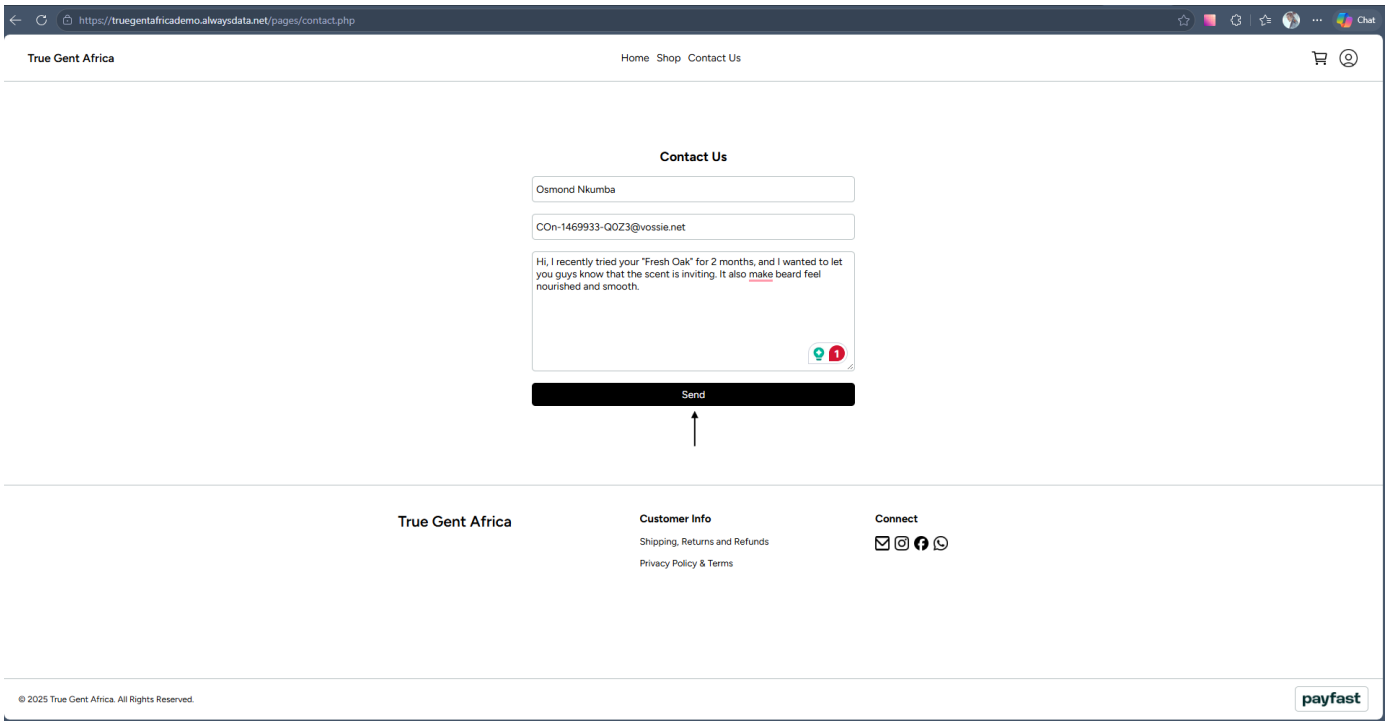
1. Navigate your cursor to the “Contact us” link and click it.



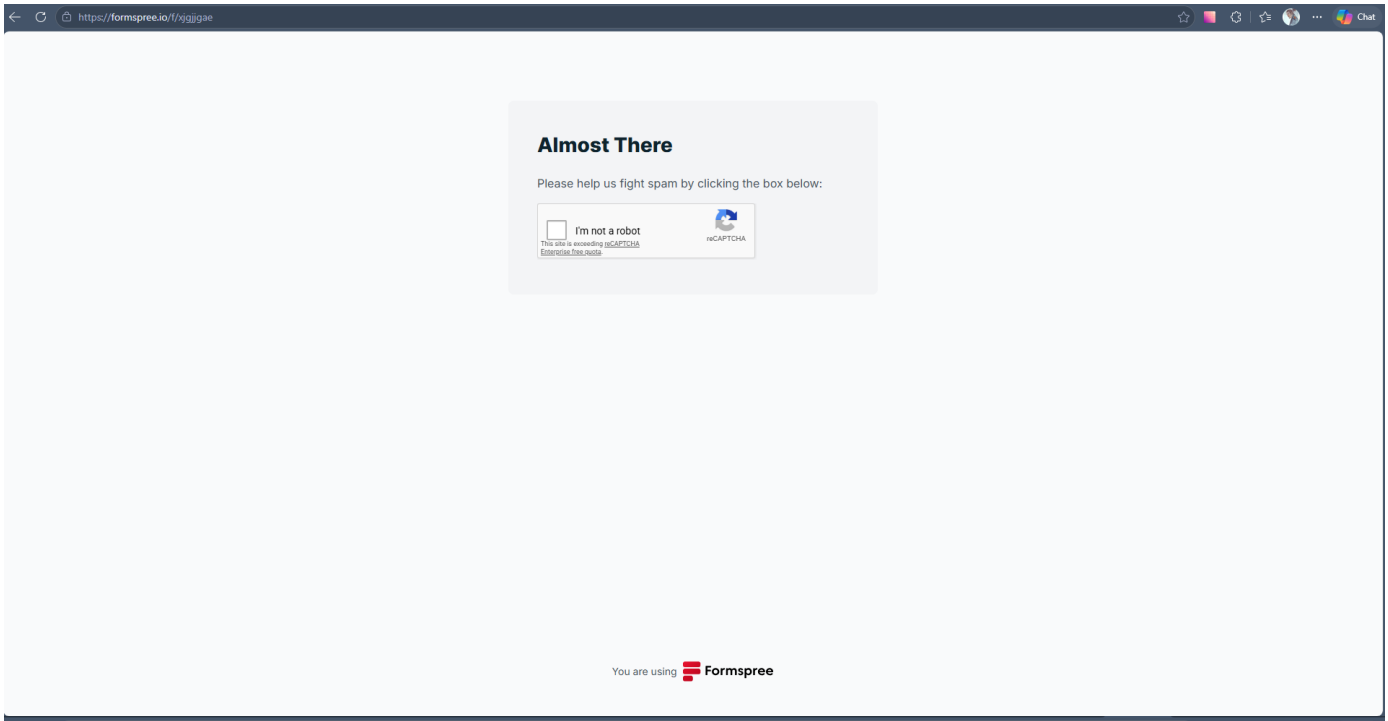
2. You can submit a contact form, if you have any reviews or queries with True Gent Africa.

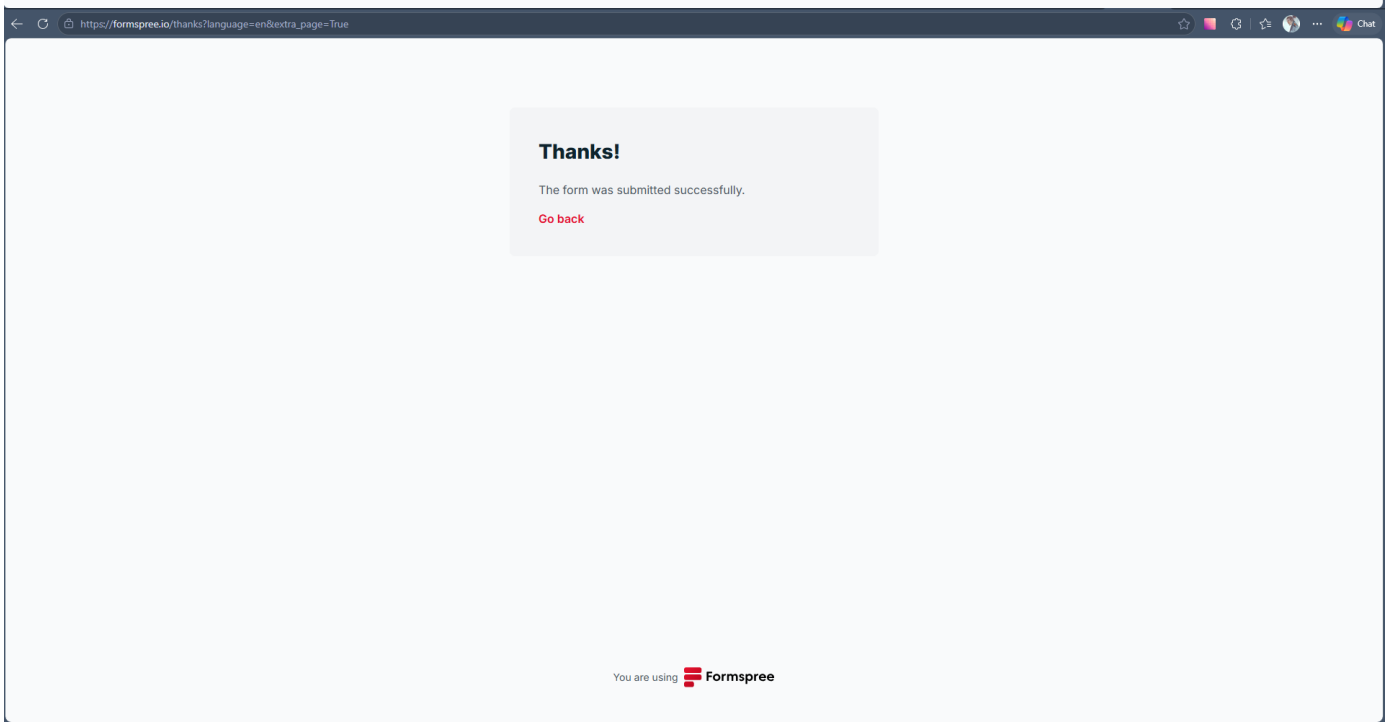


3. Fill the checkout form and click send.



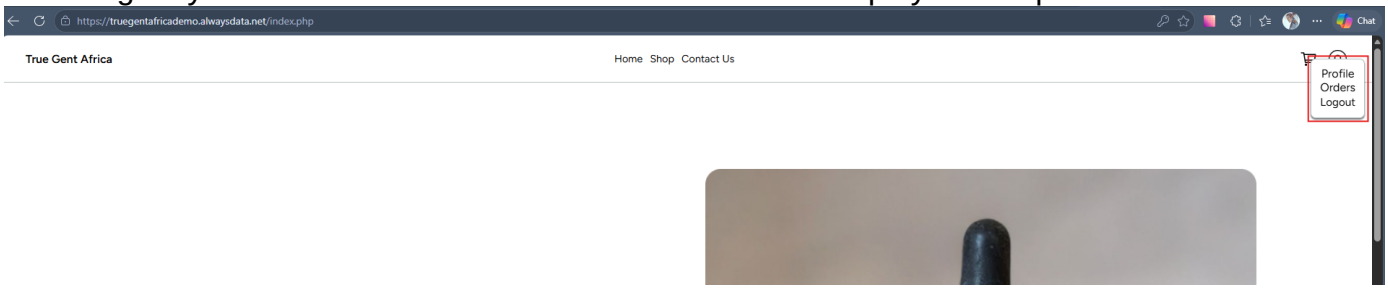
4. Submit the reCAPTCHA and you will have successfully submitted the form.



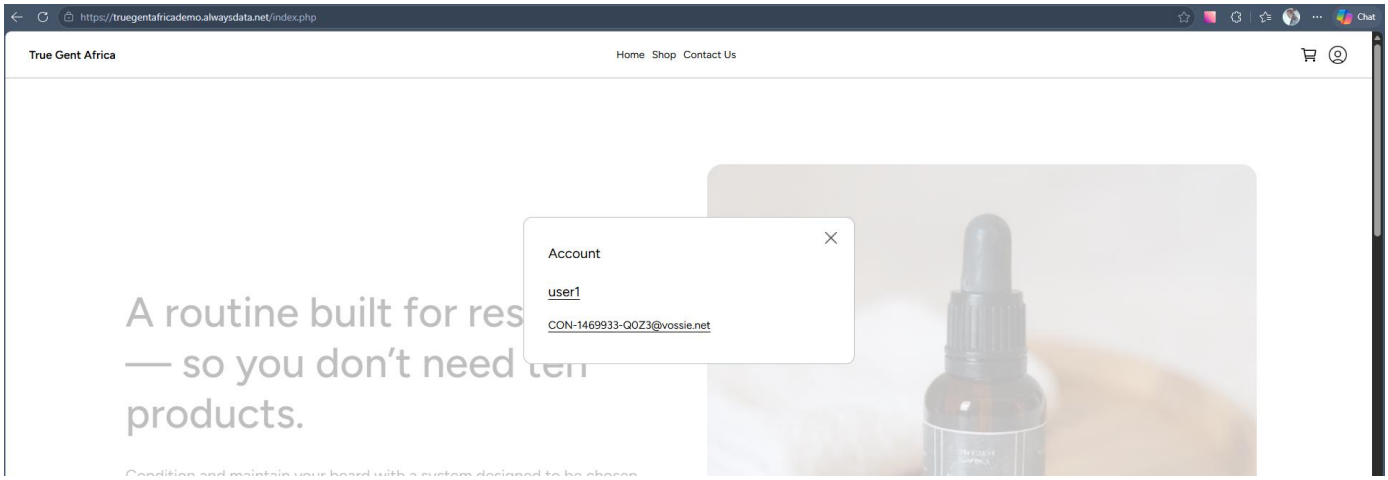


Profile Viewing

1. Navigate your cursor to the account icon and click it to display the dropdown menu.

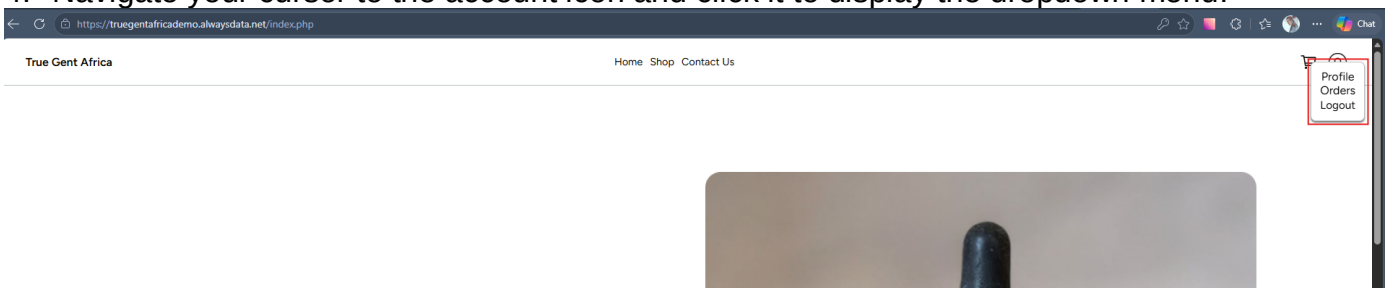


2. Click Profile.
3. An account pop-up will appear on your screen for profile viewing.

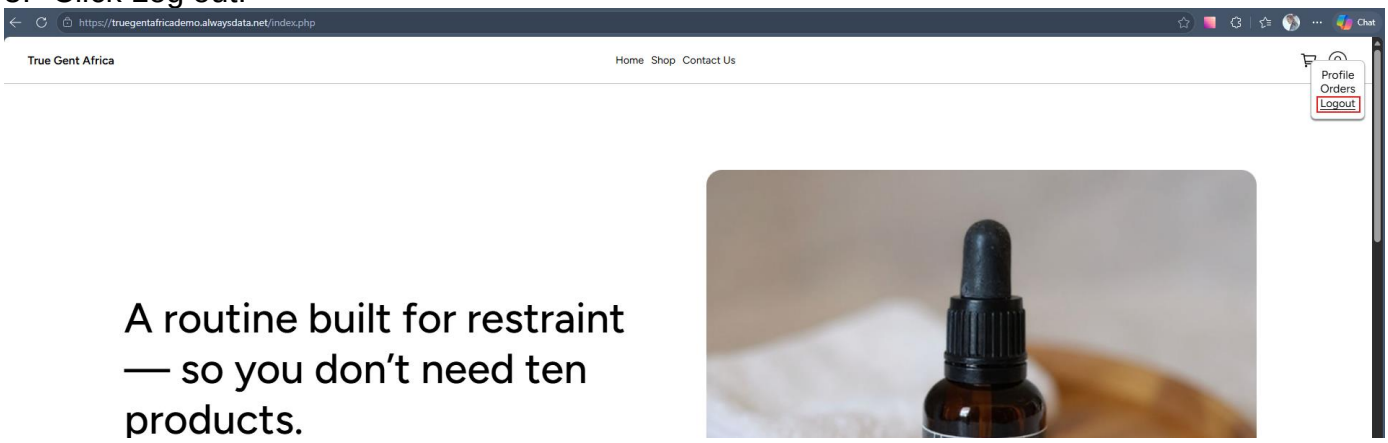


Logging out

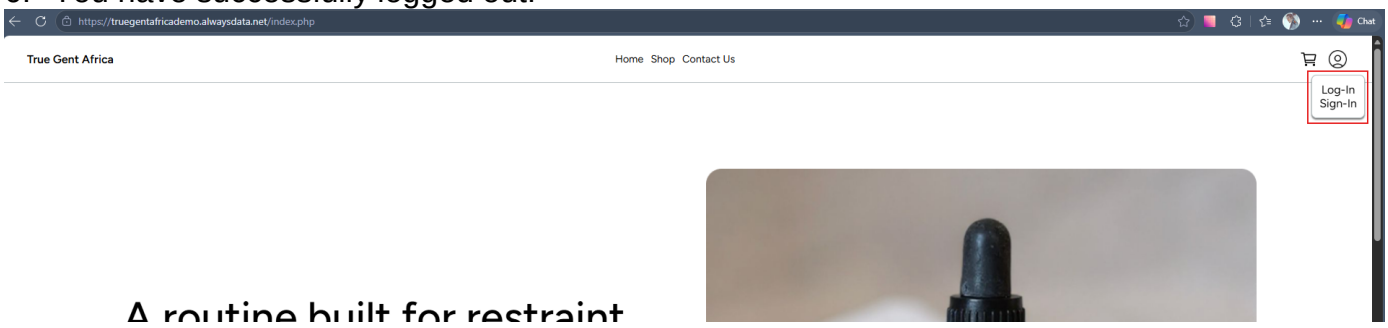
4. Navigate your cursor to the account icon and click it to display the dropdown menu.



5. Click Log out.



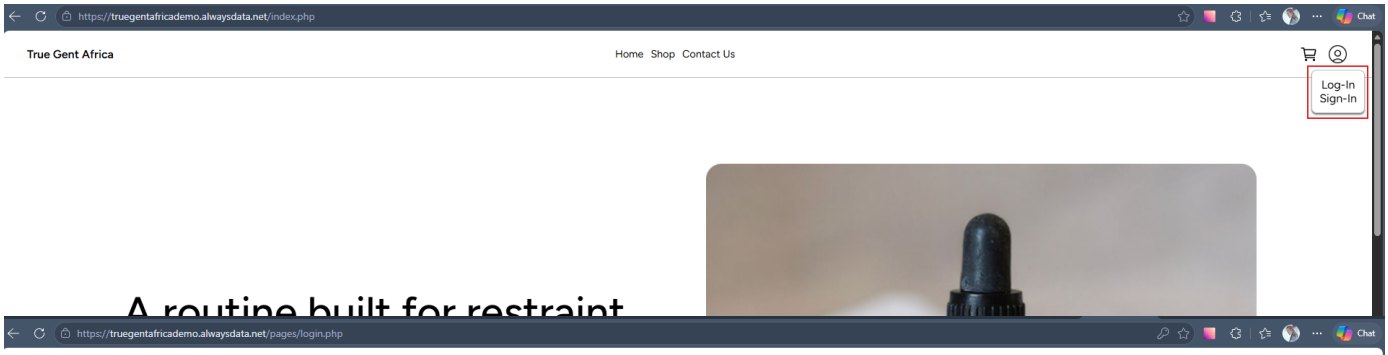
6. You have successfully logged out.

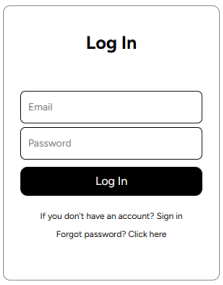


Administrator User Manual

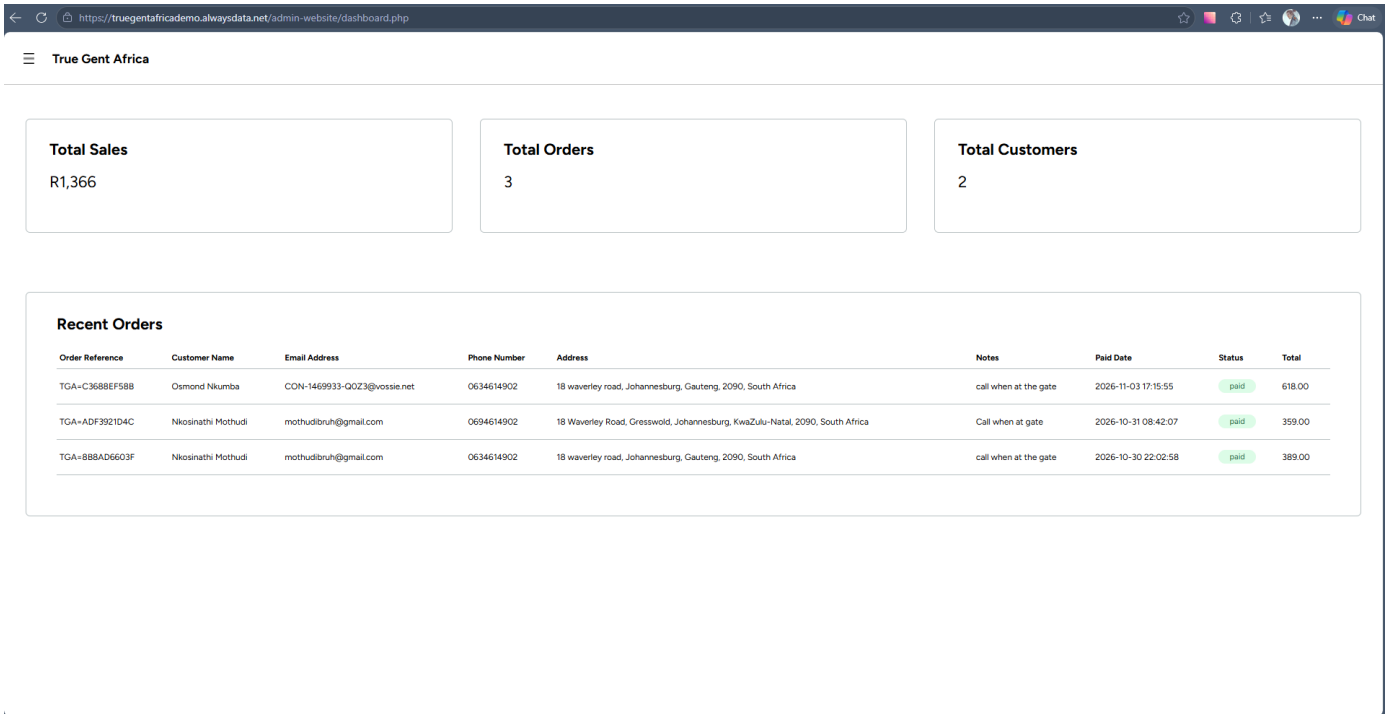
Logging In

1. Navigate to the account icon in the guest homepage and click Log-in to be redirected to the login page.



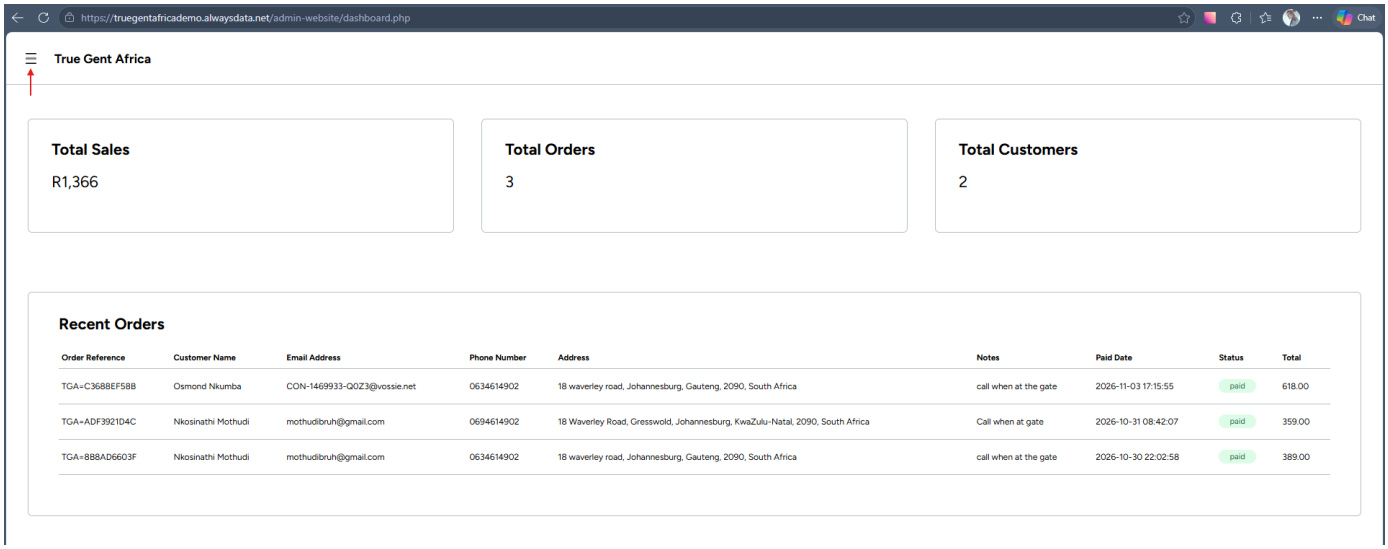


2. Fill in your administrative credentials and click Log in.
3. The system validates the credentials and permissions.
4. The administrator is redirected to the admin dashboard.

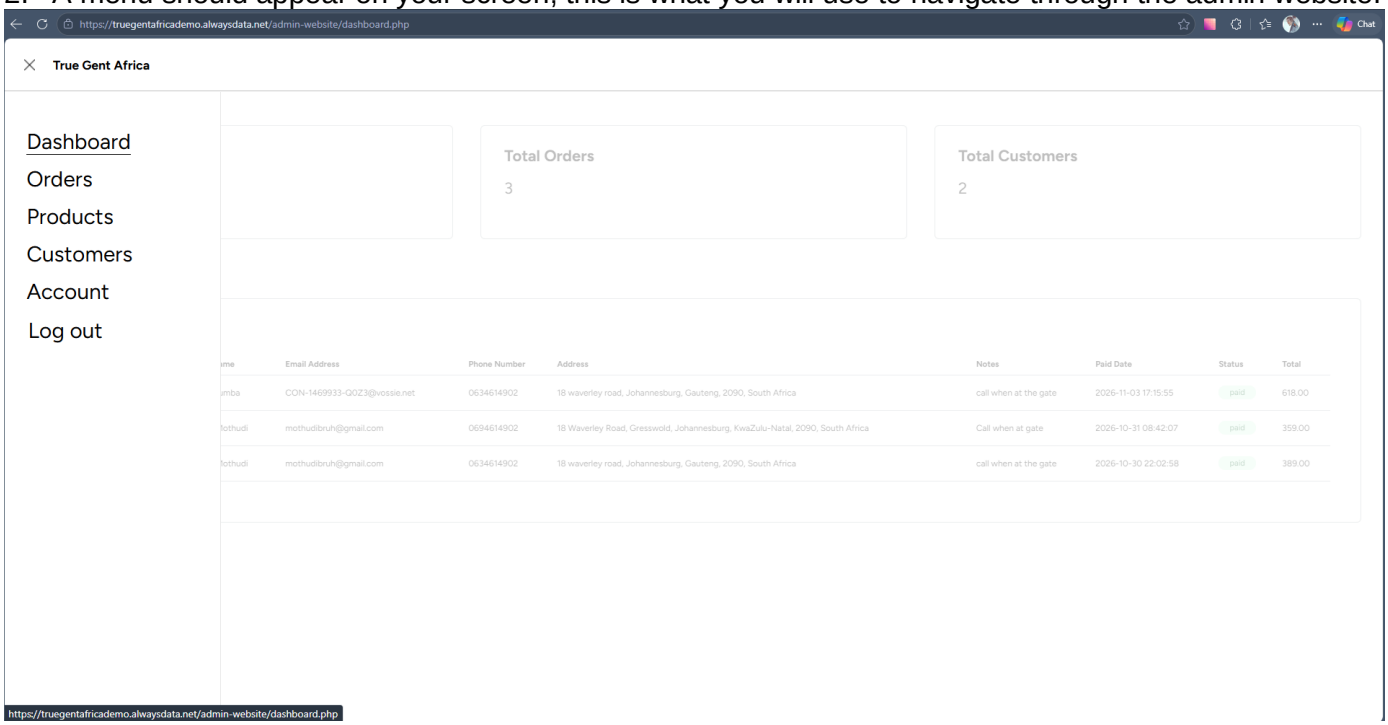


Navigating in Admin Website

1. Navigate your cursor and click the menu icon.

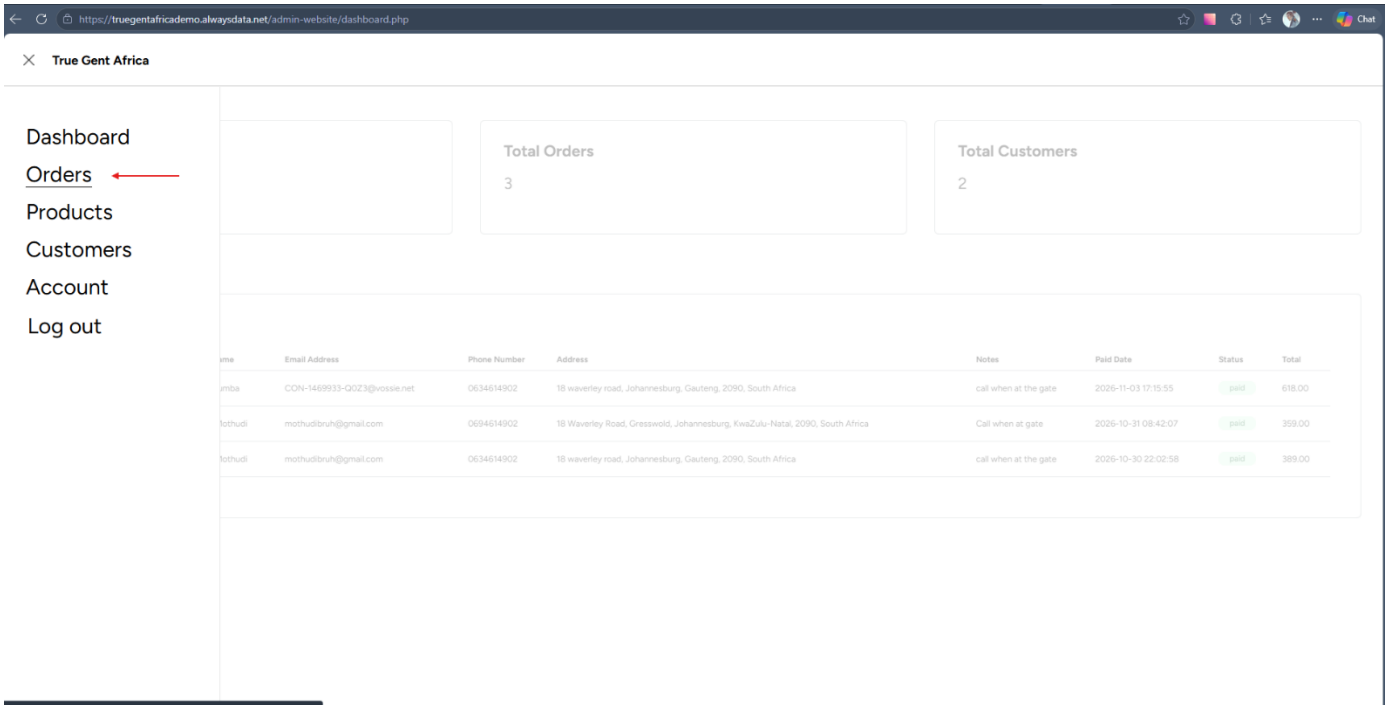


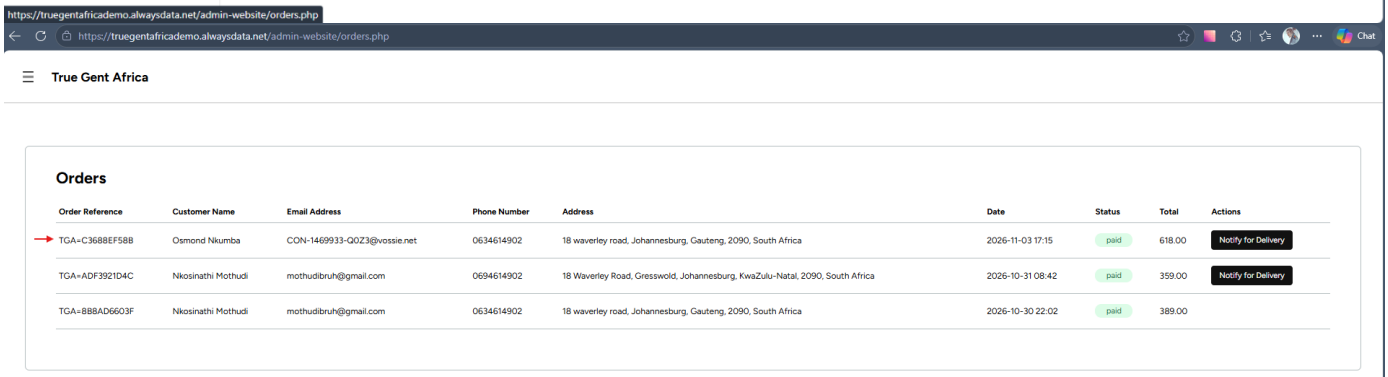
2. A menu should appear on your screen; this is what you will use to navigate through the admin website.



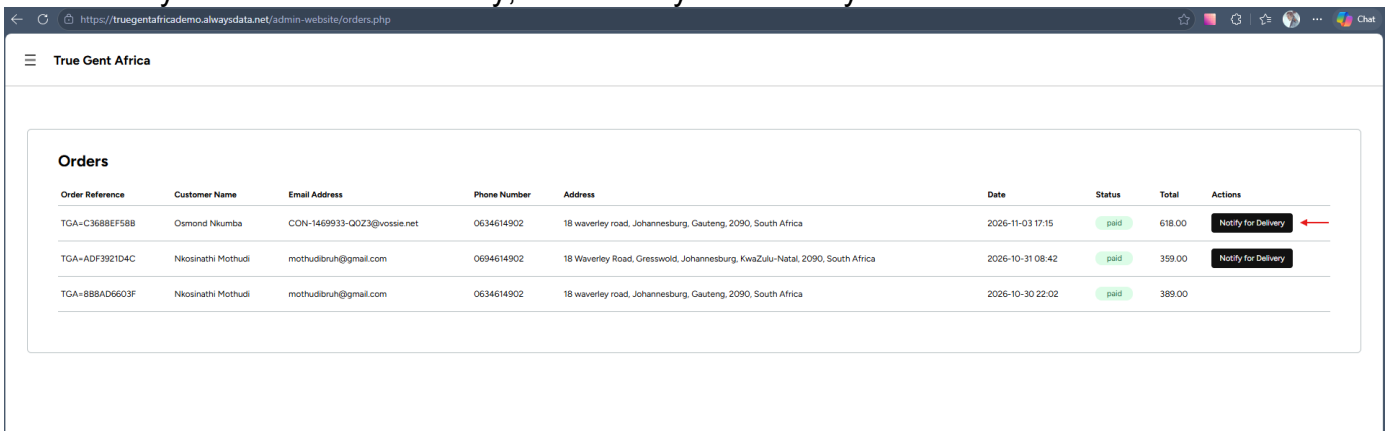
Orders

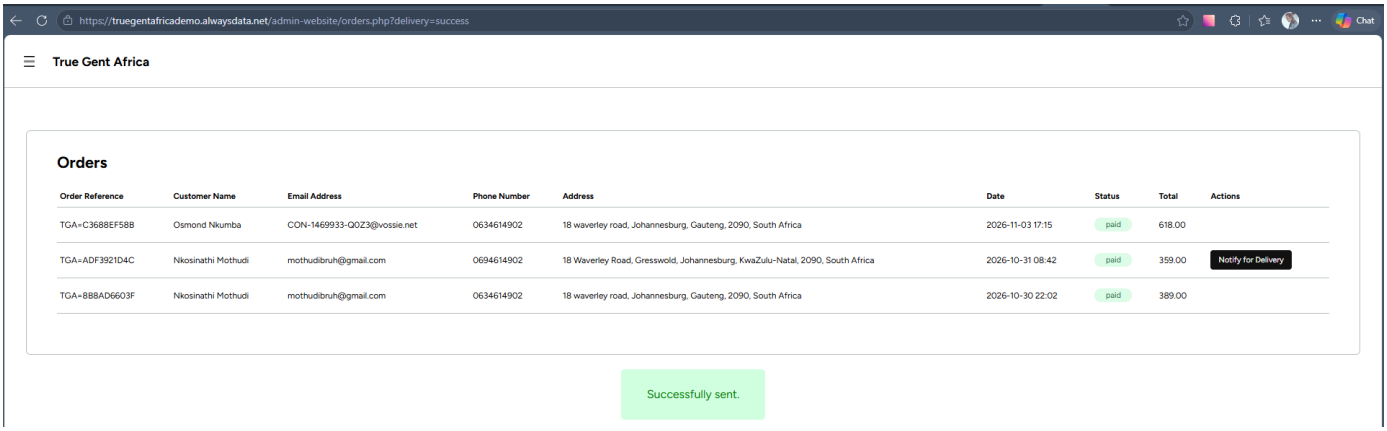
1. Click Orders to be redirected to the orders page



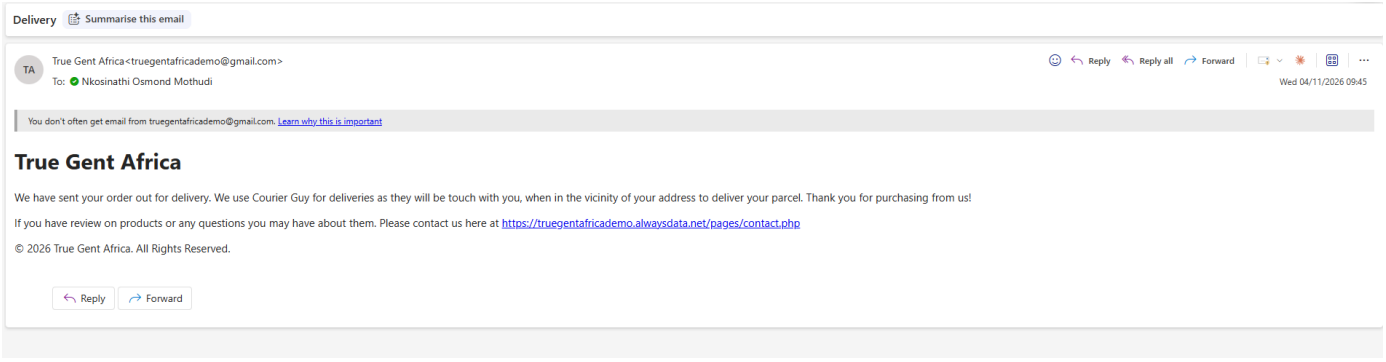


2. To notify a customer for delivery, click “Notify for Delivery”.



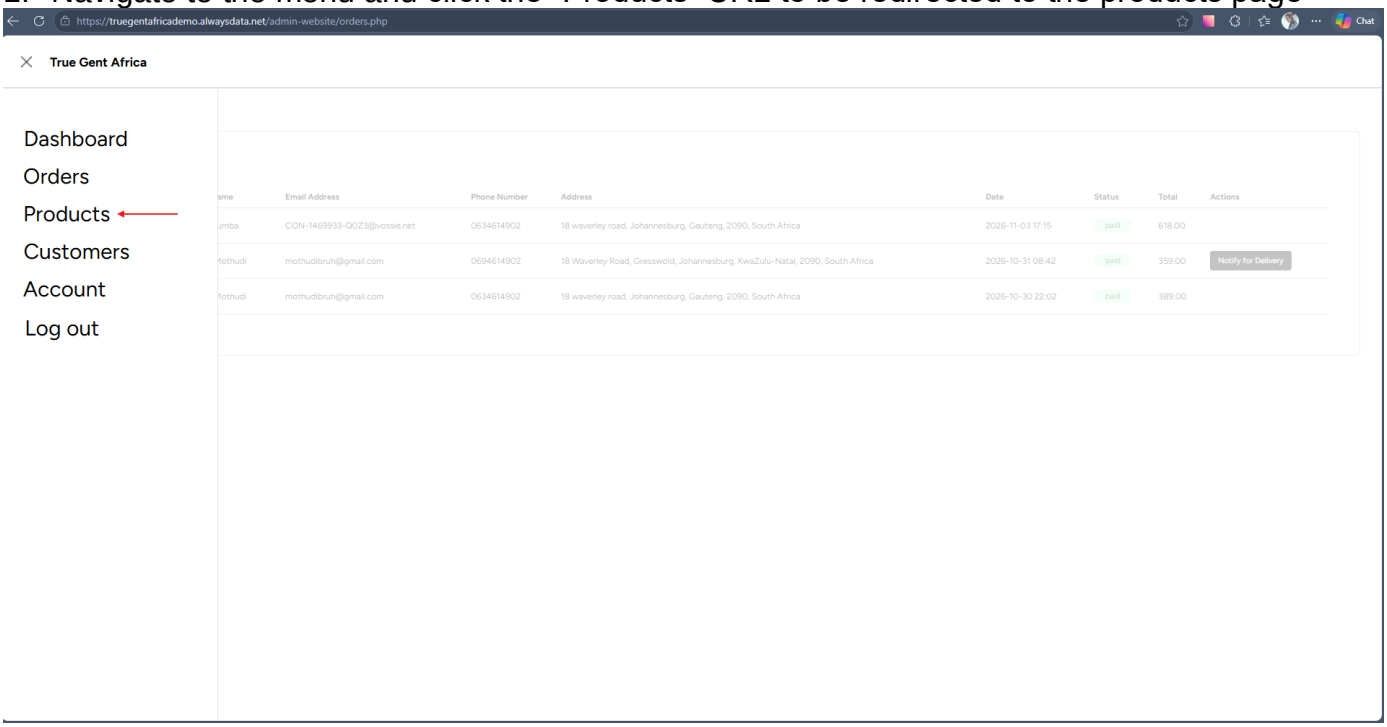


3. The customer should receive an email.

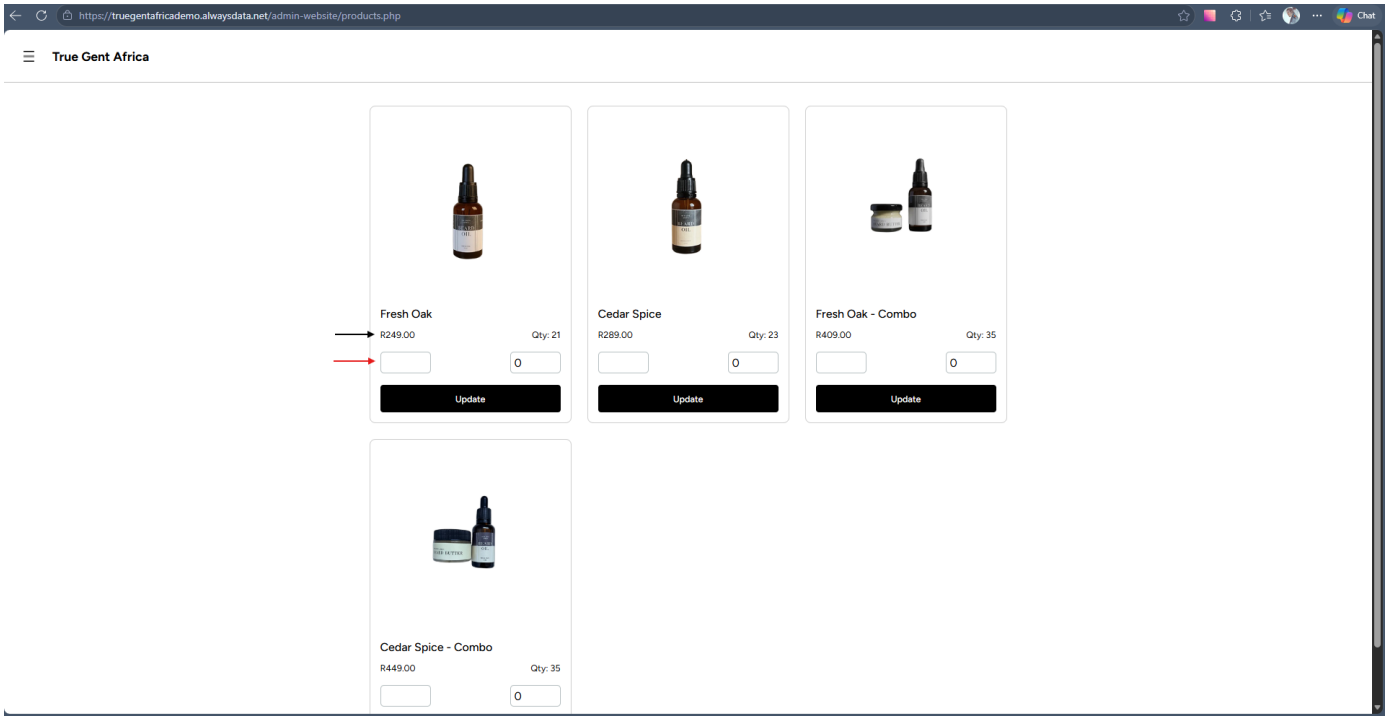


Product updating

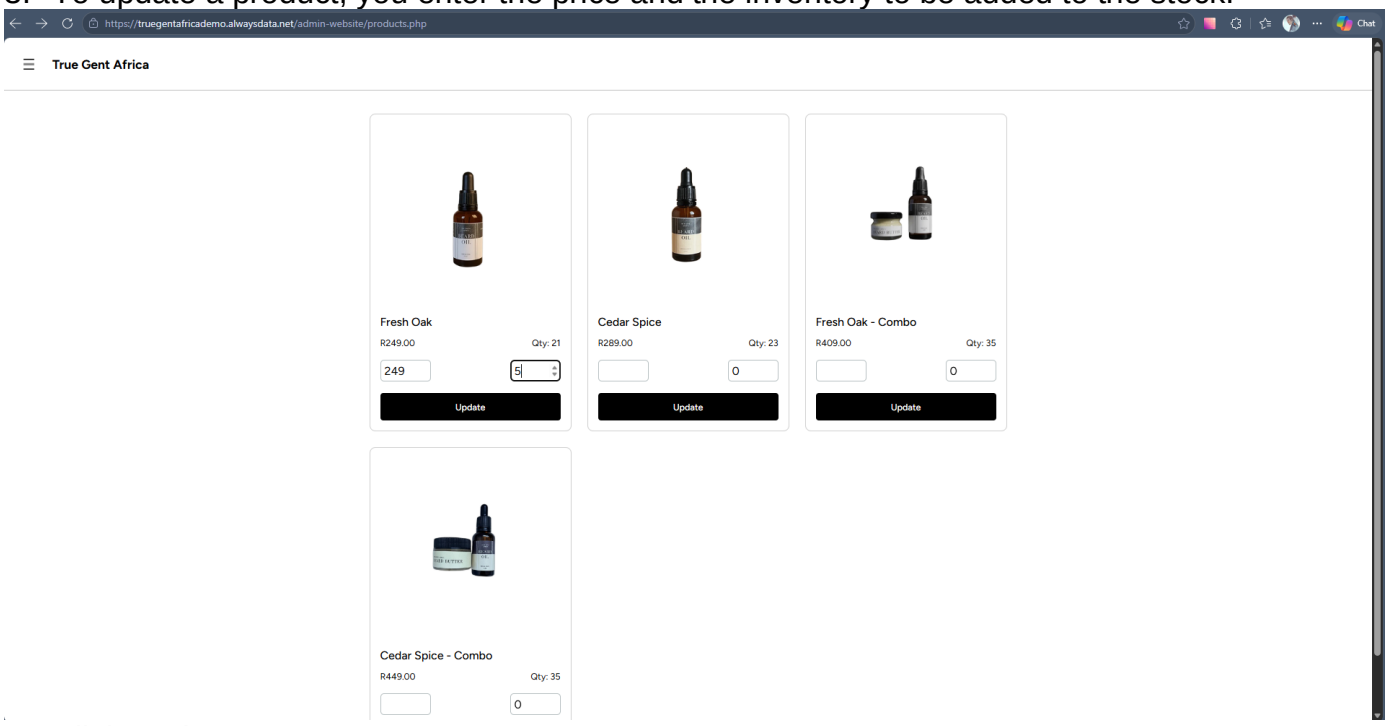
1. Navigate to the menu and click the “Products” URL to be redirected to the products page



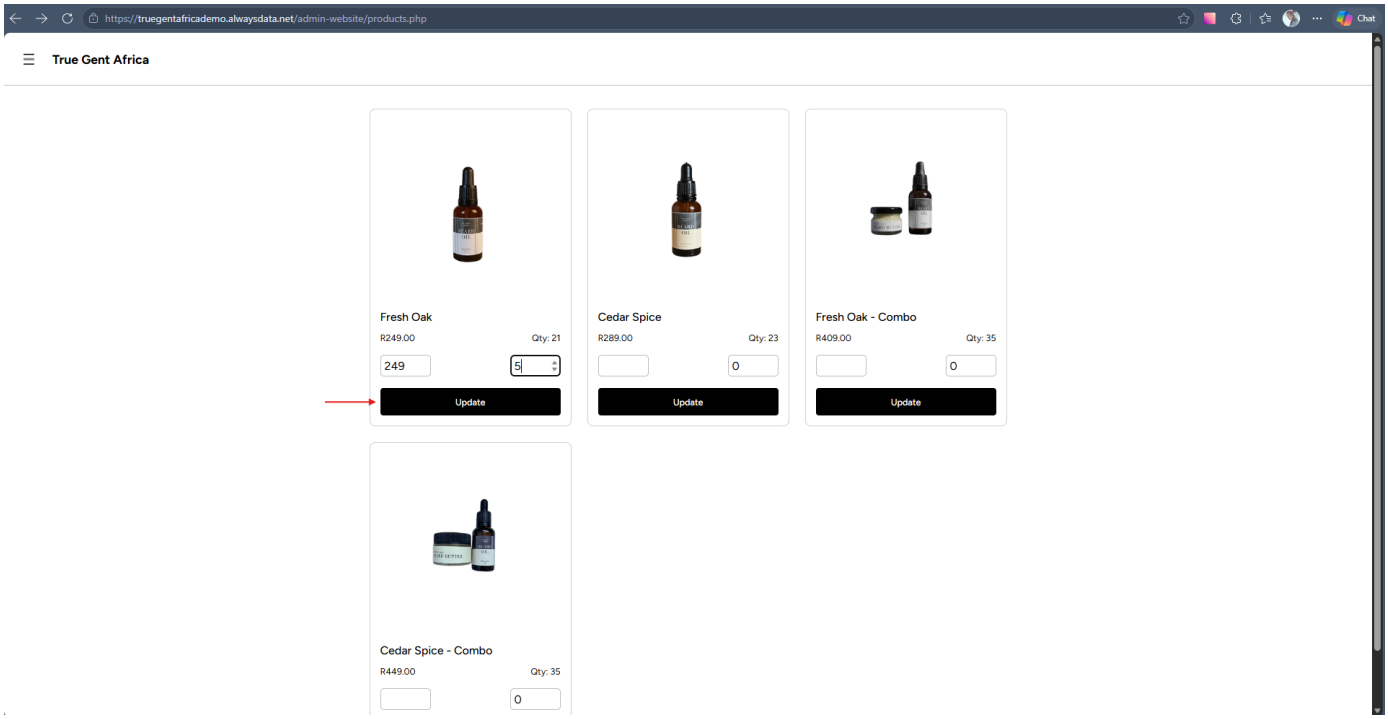
2. Note the product page display the current price and current stock level. The inputs are available for the administrator to make updates to the stock or make price changes.



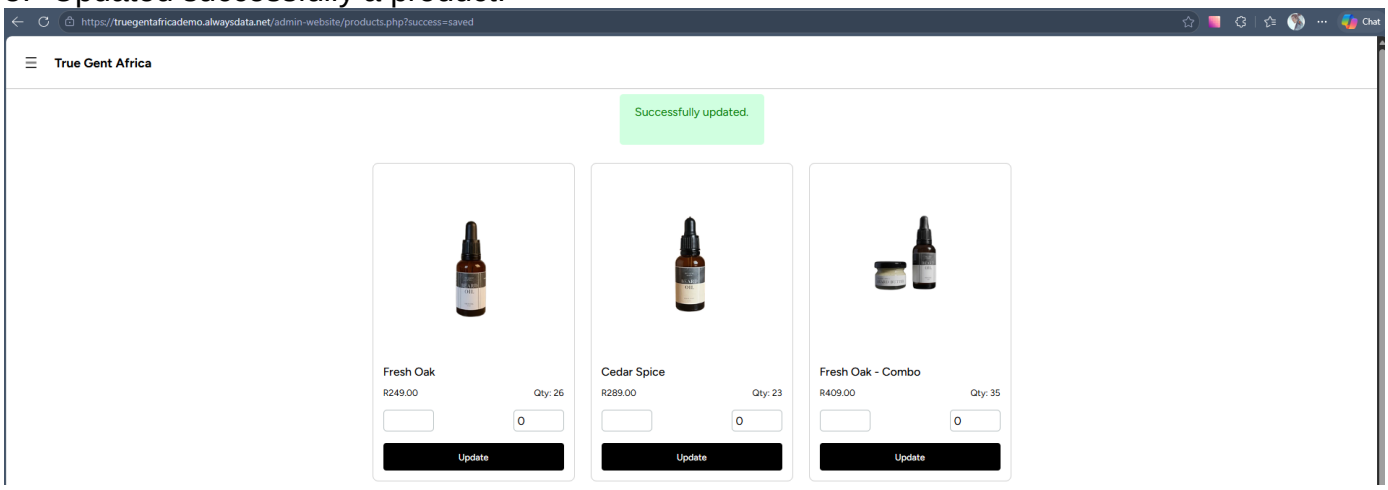
3. To update a product, you enter the price and the inventory to be added to the stock.



4. Click Update.

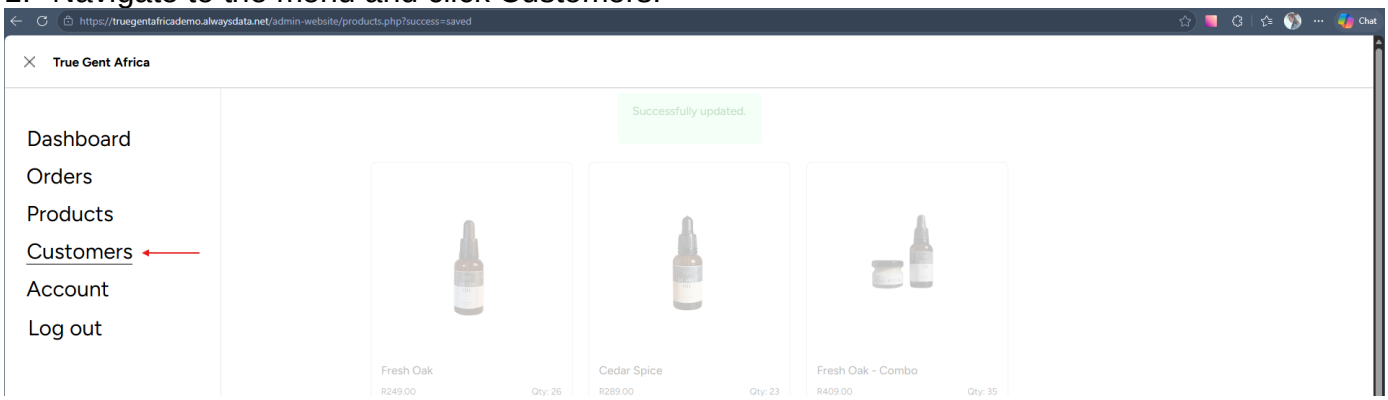


5. Updated successfully a product.

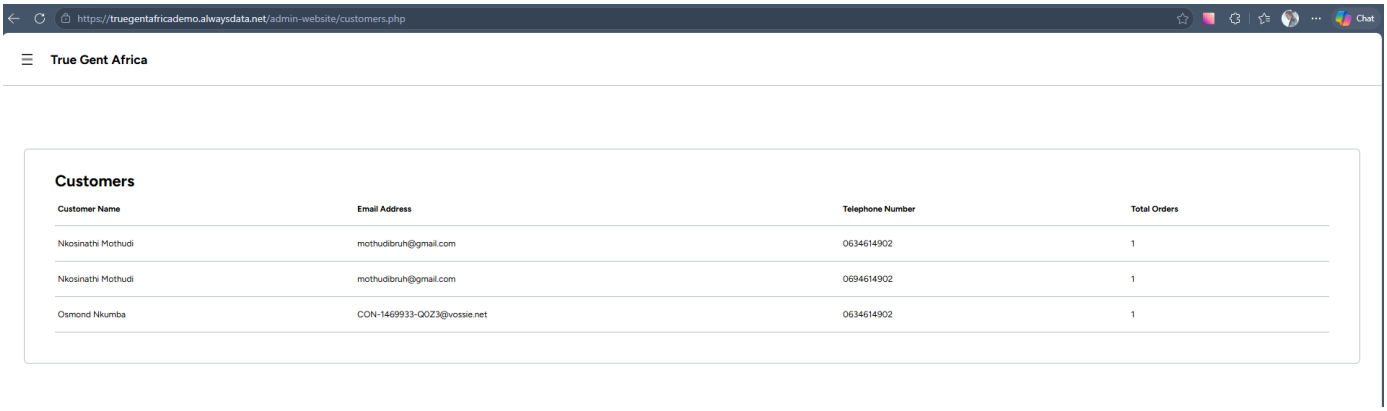


Customer Viewing

1. Navigate to the menu and click Customers.

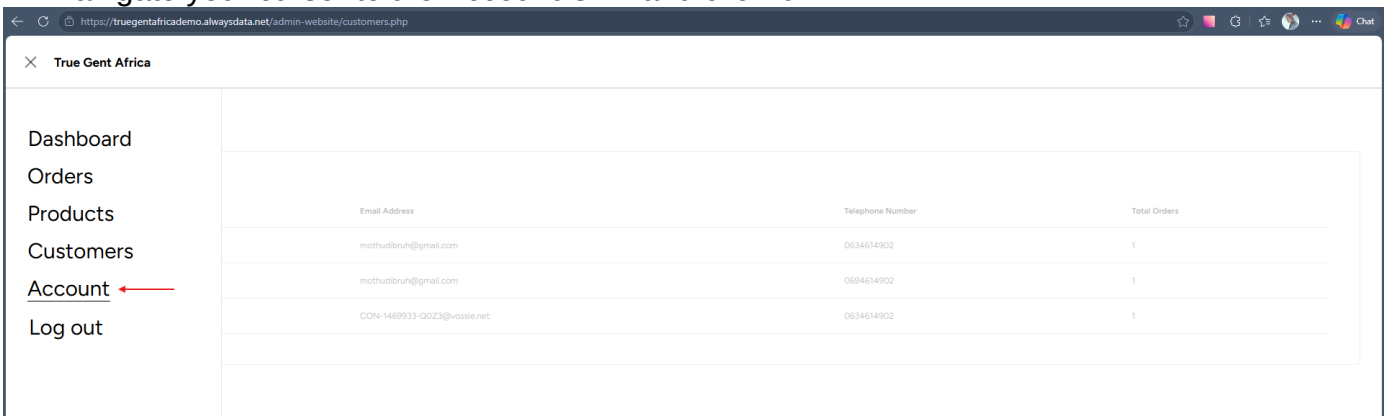


2. You can view the total orders that a customer has made as well as view their contact details.

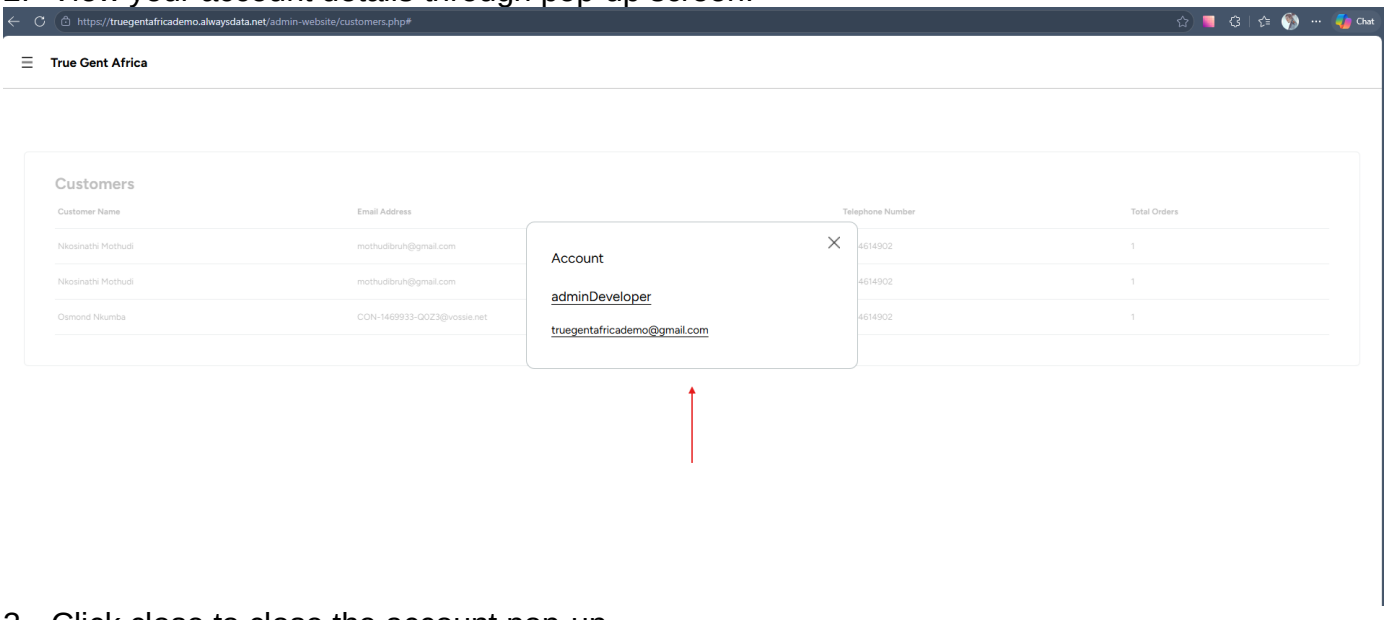


Profile Viewing
Purpose: To explain to administrative users how to view their profile.

1. Navigate your cursor to the Account URL and click it.



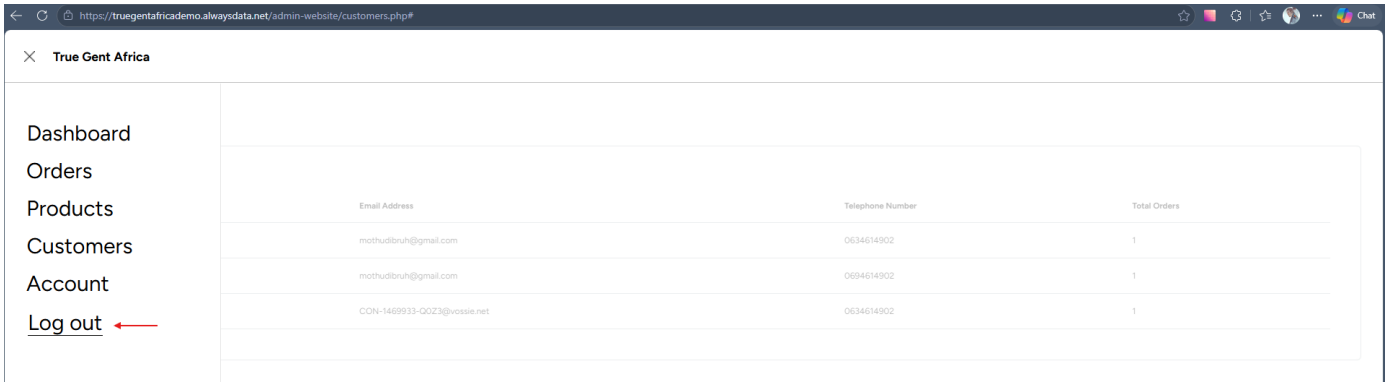
2. View your account details through pop-up screen.



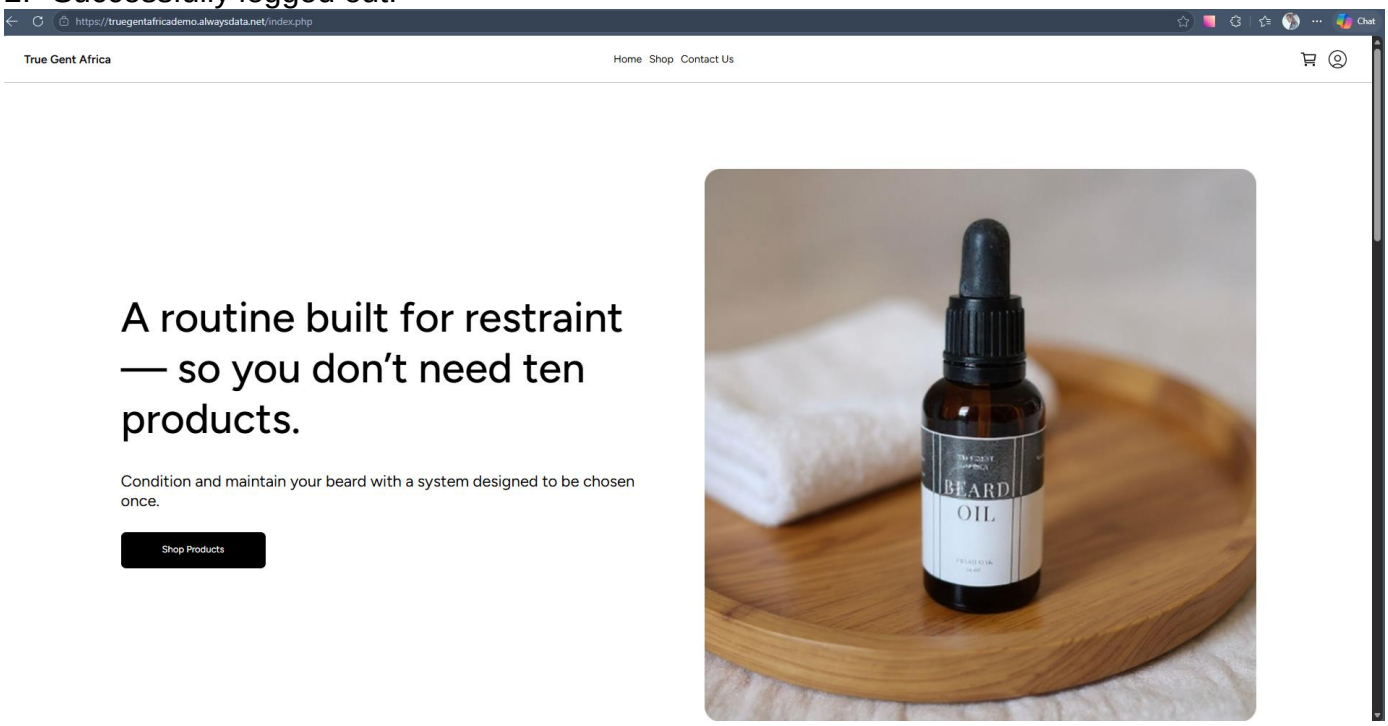
3. Click close to close the account pop-up.

Logging out

1. Navigate your cursor to the Log out and click to log out.



2. Successfully logged out.



Developer Technical Manual

This section is intended for developers responsible for building and deploying the application.

Development Environment

Component	Technology
Frontend	HTML, CSS, JavaScript
Backend	PHP
Database	MySQL
Web Server	Apache
IDE	Visual Studio Code
Version Control	Git
Repository	osmond20/ITECA-E-commerce-Project: E-commerce Project

System Installation

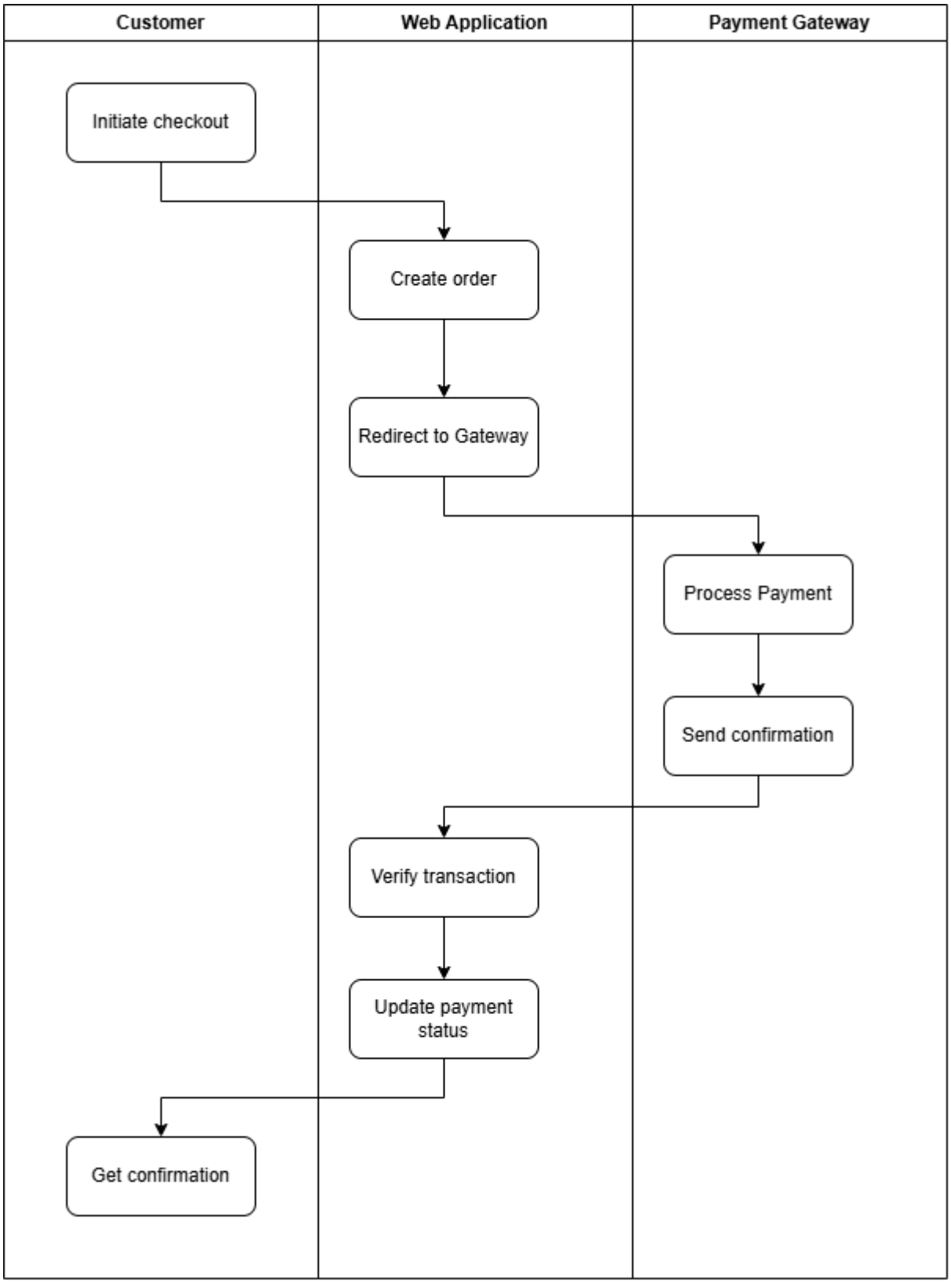
Requirements: For the system installation, the application retrieved from the code repository is required as it contains the files necessary to ensure successful system installation.

1. Use this video for setting up the PHP: PHP tutorial for beginners.
2. Download application source code files from the repository and unzip it.
3. Place the application folder with its files under the htdocs folder under the "xampp" folder in the C: drive of your computer.
4. Open your XAMPP control panel and start Apache and MySQL. - Note if an error occurs for

MySQL, another service on your computer is connect to that port that is also using MySQL.

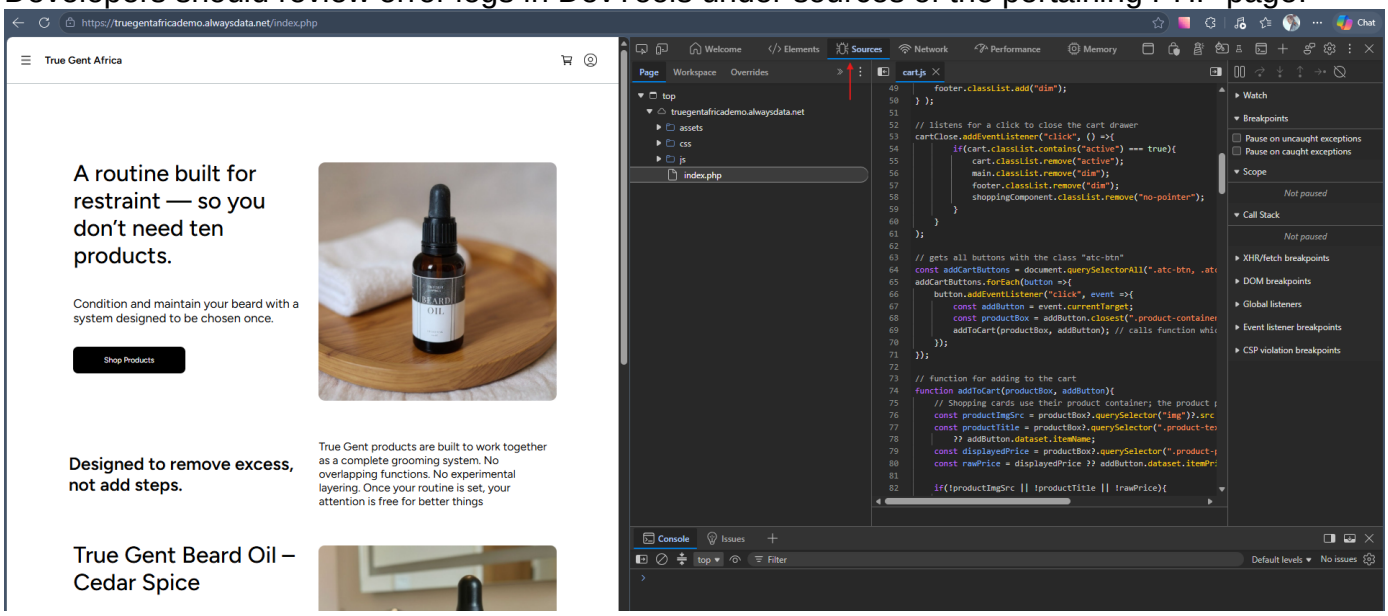
5. Create the application database in MySQL (e_commerce_database).
6. Import the SQL database from the application source code files.
7. Configure the database connection for local deployment.
8. Open the application in your dedicated browser.
9. Ensure that the application runs correctly.

Payment Gateway Integration



Application Maintenance

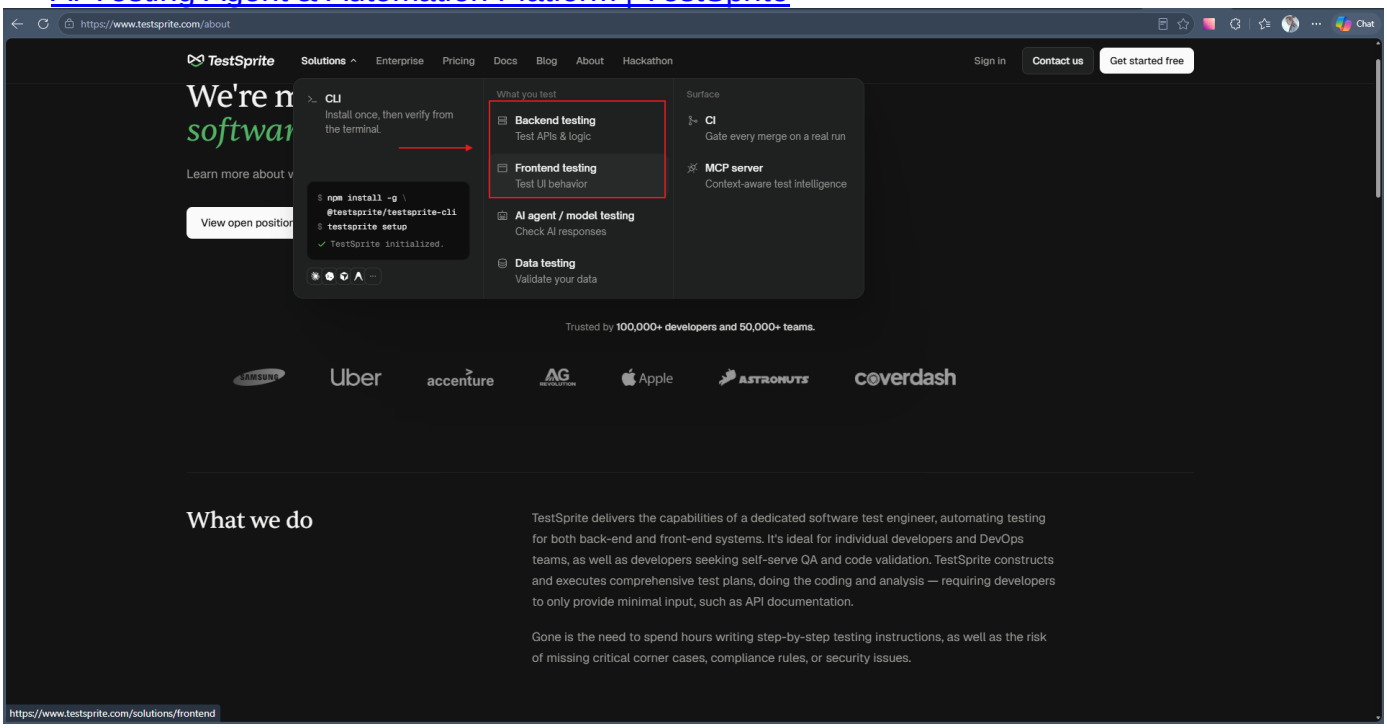
Developers should review error logs in DevTools under sources of the pertaining PHP page.



For making application changes, the developer is required to create a separate branch using Git to make changes or resolve errors for the application and merge it back into the main branch.

For testing code before merging it into the main branch and deployment:

- [AI Testing Agent & Automation Platform | TestSprite]

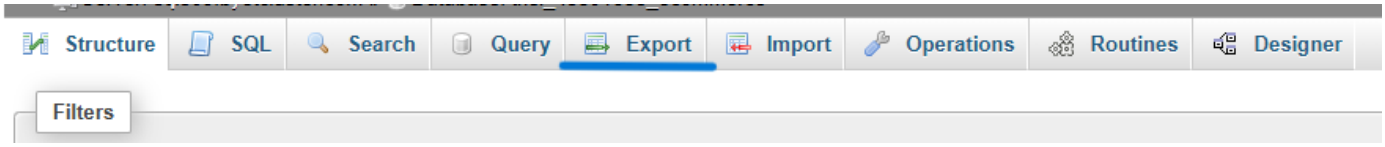


Choose any of these for your dedicated testing.

Deployment configuration

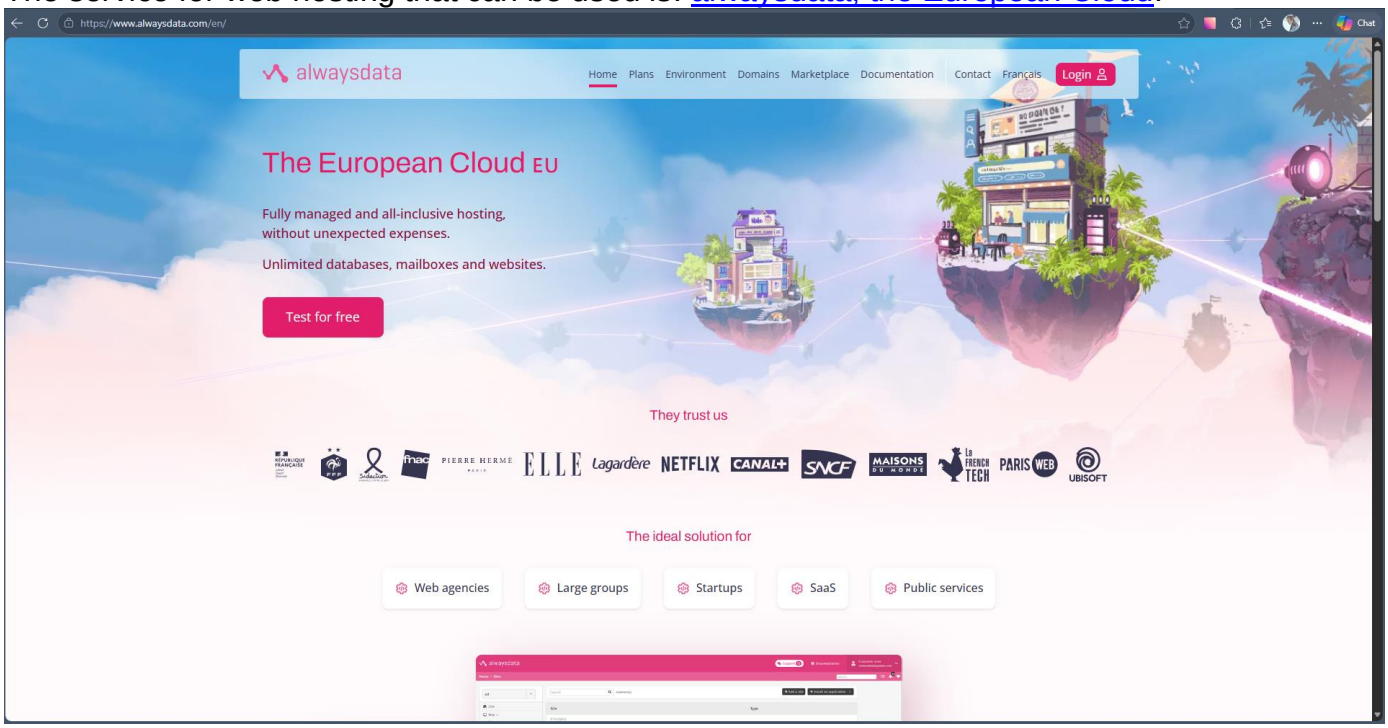
Requirements for deployment:

- Exported sql database from MySQL.



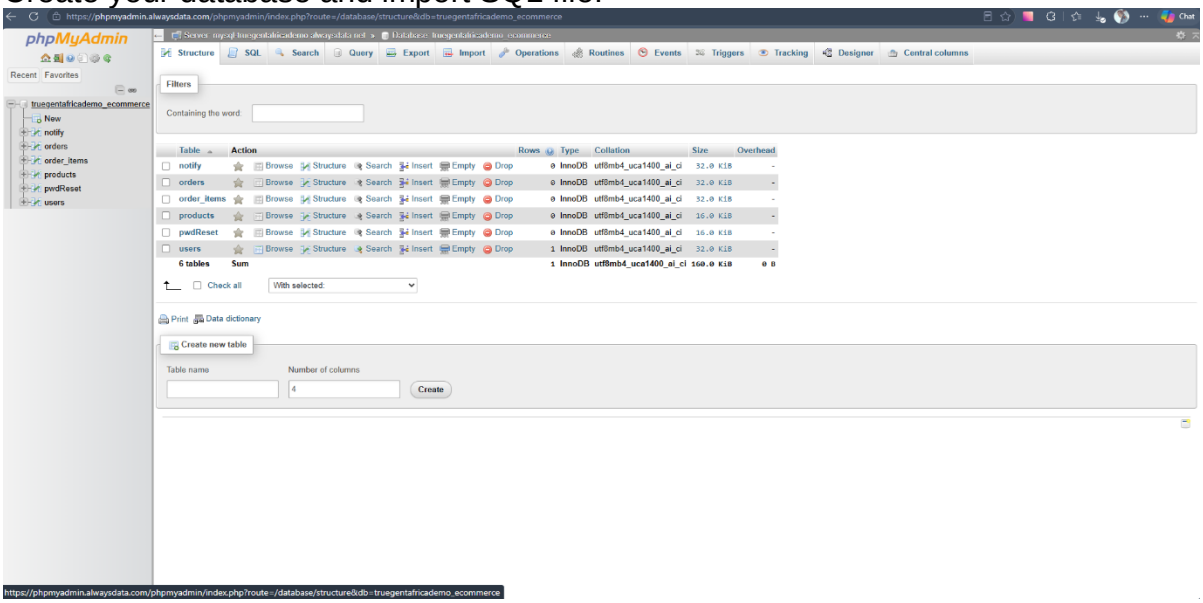
- FileZilla: [Download FileZilla Client for Windows (64bit x86)]

The service for web hosting that can be used is: [alwaysdata, the European Cloud].



Step-to-Step guide to host successfully:

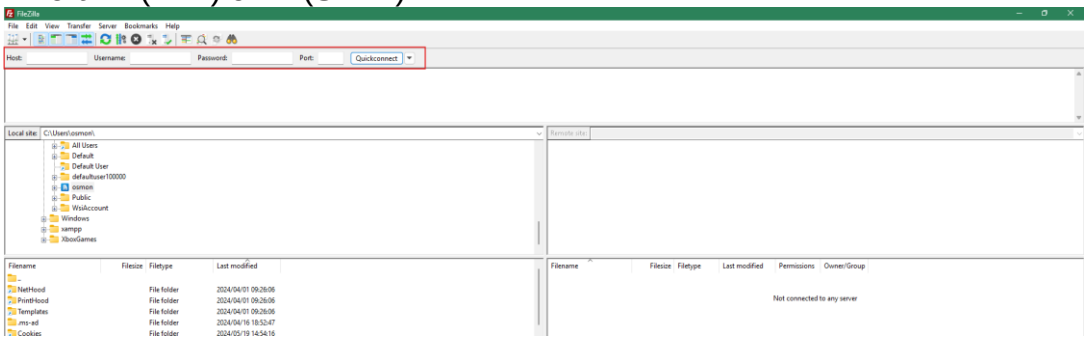
1. Set up your account on alwaysdata
   - Sign up for a free account
   - Look at the account dashboard and take note of your account username.
   - Create your database and import SQL file.



   - For further information on database configuration: [MariaDB - MySQL | alwaysdata]
2. Install File Zilla and Configure Client (for more further information: [Uploading Files with FileZilla | alwaysdata])
   - After installing FileZilla, open it on your computer
   - Navigate to your Always Data admin dashboard and under Remote Access.



- Choose either SFTP or FTP to get your credentials
- Enter your credentials:
  i. Host: ssh-[your account-name].alwaysdata.net
  ii. Username: Your alwaysdata username
  iii. Password: Your alwaysdata account password.
  iv. Port: 21(FTP) or 22(SFTP)



- Click QuickConnect (If prompted with an unknown host key certificate warning, check “Always trust this host”, and click OK. Enter your password again if required)

3. Update database connection in PHP code
   - Before uploading files, update your database configuration file (e.g. db.php or conn.php) on your computer so it can connect to alwaysdata’s database server instead of localhost.

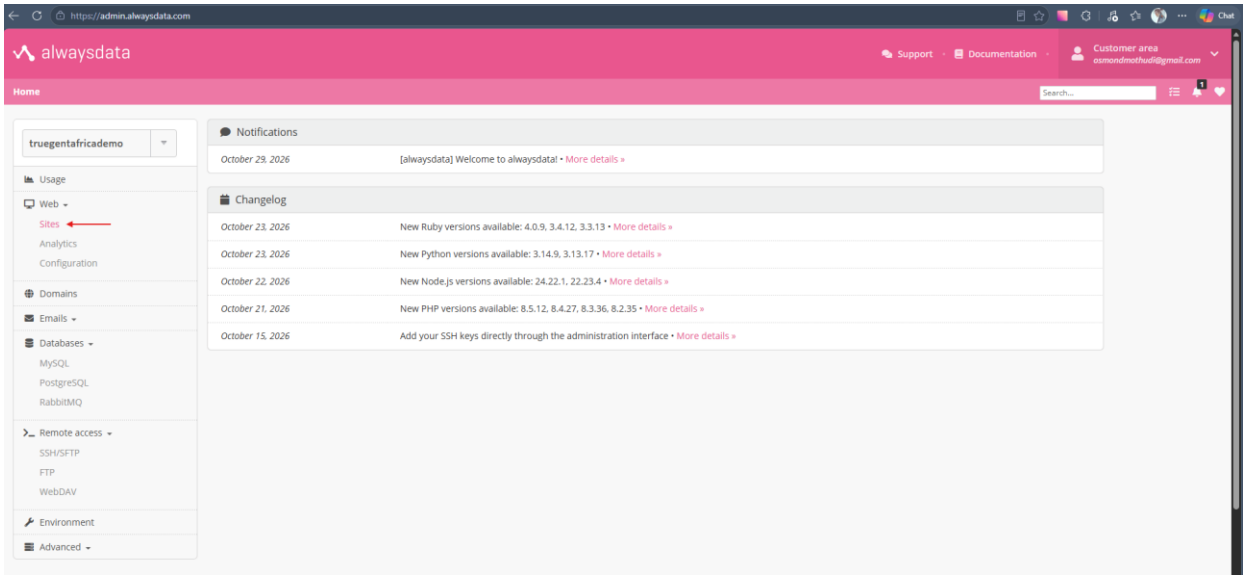
```php
<?php
    // setting up vairables for database connection
    // fill in with your own credentials
    $servername = "";
    $dBUserName = "";
    $dBPassword = '';
    $dbName = "";


    // storing connection in a variable
    $conn = mysqli_connect($servername, $dBUserName, $dBPassword, $dbName);

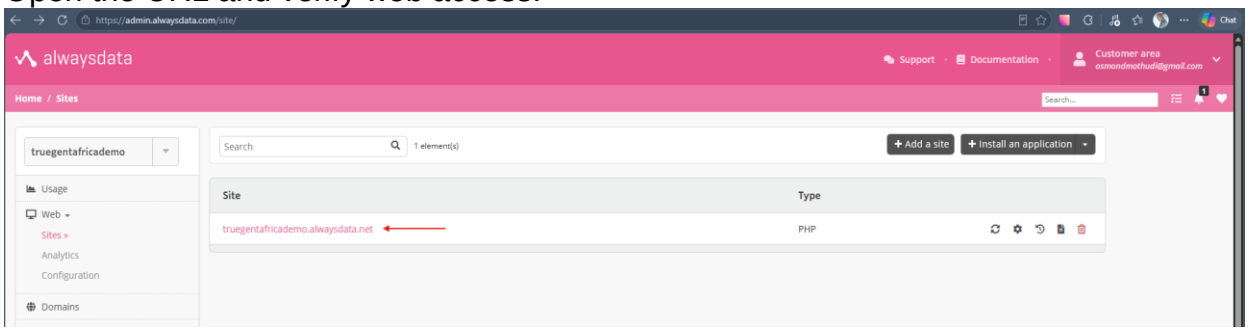
    // checking connection and returns an error message if the connection fails
    if(!$conn){
        // throwing an error if connection is unsuccessful
        error_log('Database connection failed: ' . mysqli_connect_error());
        http_response_code(500);
        exit('The service is temporarily unavailable.');
    }
    mysqli_set_charset($conn, 'utf8mb4');

?>
```

4. Upload your files to FileZilla:
   - In FileZilla, you will see two panels:
     i. Left panel (Local Site): Your local computer’s file directories
     ii. Right panel (Remote Site): The server’s file directories
   - In the right panel, navigate to www and drop all your files from the left panel there.
5. Configure the web address and test
   - Return to your alwaysadmin Admin Panel.
   - Go to Web > Sites in the left menu.



- Open the URL and verify web access.



Troubleshooting

Problem	Possible Cause	Recommended Solution
Unable to log in	Incorrect credentials	Check use of correct email or password. Alternatively reset password or create a new account.
Products are not displaying	Database or application Fetch error.	Check database records and use DevTools to inspect console log errors on JavaScript code.
Unable to add product to cart	Session or application error	Check the session and debug add to cart functionality.
Payment is unsuccessful	Gateway error, or declined transaction	Check configuration setting for pay fast and test the backend code using TestSprite to identify any subtle bugs.
Admin dashboard not successfully loading order	Database connection error or application error	Check application code successfully fetches orders from database
Database connection fails	Incorrect configuration	Ensure the application has the correct configuration settings to connect to the database

References

- How to create a user manual: 8 steps and a checklist. (n.d.). Scalar. https://scalar.apidocumentation.com/library/how-to-create-a-user-manual?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- alwaysdata, the European Cloud. (n.d.). Retrieved November 4, 2026, from https://www.alwaysdata.com/en/
- Wills, B. (2026, September 25). User manual template for web applications: How to create one. Knowledgebase Blog. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from https://www.proprofskb.com/blog/create-user-manual-for-web-applications/
- Karpenkova, A. (2026, September 4). How to write an Easy-to-Follow User Manual [+Free Templates]. Scribe. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from https://scribe.com/library/user-manual-template
- Ademola-Shanu, W. (2026b, September 4). What Is Technical Documentation? Best Practices & Tips. Scribe. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from https://scribe.com/library/what-is-technical-documentation
- Hadley, C., & Hadley, C. (2026, July 12). Software User Manual: The Ultimate guide with examples and template. HeroThemes - Happier Customers, Fewer Support Tickets. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from https://herothemes.com/blog/software-user-manual-guide-examples/
- Download FileZilla Client for MacOS (Intel). (n.d.). https://filezilla-project.org/download.php?type=client
- Alwaysdata. (n.d.). SFTP. Alwaysdata. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from https://help.alwaysdata.com/en/docs/web-hosting/remote-access/sftp/#:~:text=SFTP.%20SFTP%2C%20the%20SSH%20File%20Transfer%20Protocol%2C,user%3A%20%5Baccount%5D%20*%20password.%20*%20hostname%3A%20ssh%2D%5Baccount%5D.
- Alwaysdata. (n.d.-b). Uploading Files with FileZilla. Alwaysdata. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from https://help.alwaysdata.com/en/docs/web-hosting/remote-access/ftp/use-filezilla/
- Alwaysdata. (n.d.-a). *MariaDB - MySQL*. Alwaysdata. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from

  https://help.alwaysdata.com/en/docs/web-hosting/databases/mariadb/

- *Check out this chat*. (n.d.-b). ChatGPT. Retrieved November 4, 2026, from

  https://chatgpt.com/share/6aeb9224-5eb0-83e8-b6b6-73e9da103d0d

AI Disclosure Appendix

AI tool used	Purpose / how it was used	How I verified or adapted the output
ChatGPT 4o	Used for providing a template on how to approach a user manual	Validated it with other sources to ensure that my template was not inaccurate.

Declaration:

I/we declare that this assessment is my/our own original work, except for source material explicitly acknowledged. I/we confirm that any use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) tools has been applied only as permitted by the assessment instructions and has been fully disclosed where required.

I/we understand that I/we remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, and academic quality of this submission. I/we am/are aware of the institution's policies on academic integrity and the requirements relating to the responsible use of AI in assessments.

I/we acknowledge that failure to comply with these requirements, including undeclared or inappropriate AI use, may result in academic penalties or disciplinary procedures in accordance with institutional policy.

Student Signature(s)	Date
	**2026/11/04**